

Spring 2024

Research
September 2024

TRANSIT



Customer Satisfaction Survey Background

- Covers all modes – Bus, Rail, Light Rail & Access Link
- Conducted in Spring and Fall
- Methodology has remained consistent to track scores over time
  - Customers rate their satisfaction with service traits on a scale of 0 to 10
  - Customers identify the most important service traits
- Survey is administered online with an extensive campaign to increase participation and boost response rates in target markets

TRANSIT

Customer Satisfaction Survey

Spring 2024 Survey Background

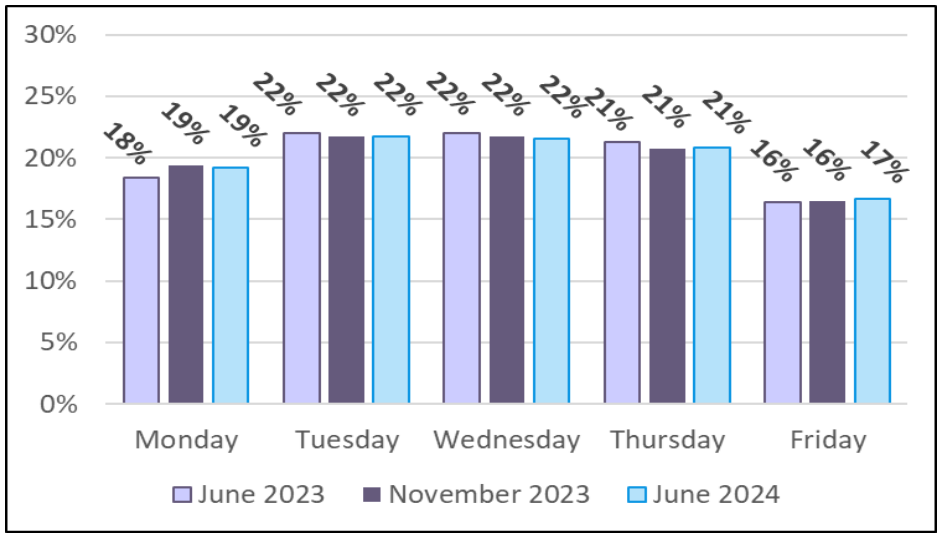
- Conducted from May 15th through June 14th
- Received about 44,000 surveys
- Survey included standard Customer Satisfaction questions and COVID-related questions
- To encourage more participation -- offered 250 NJT Rewards Points to all customers that completed the survey and were a member or signed up for NJT Rewards

TRANSIT

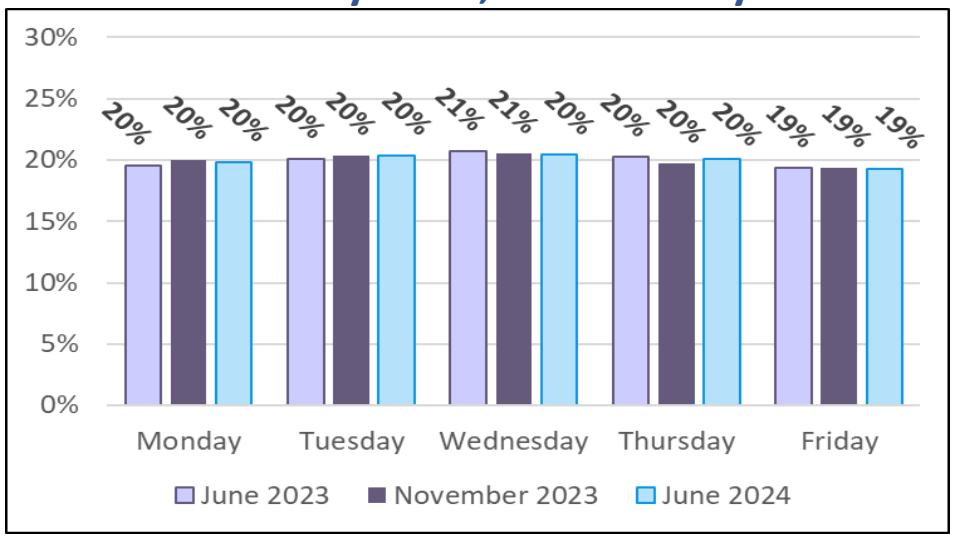
COVID-Related Findings
Distribution of Weekday Work Trips on NJ TRANSIT by Day of the Week

Customer Satisfaction Survey
Spring 2024

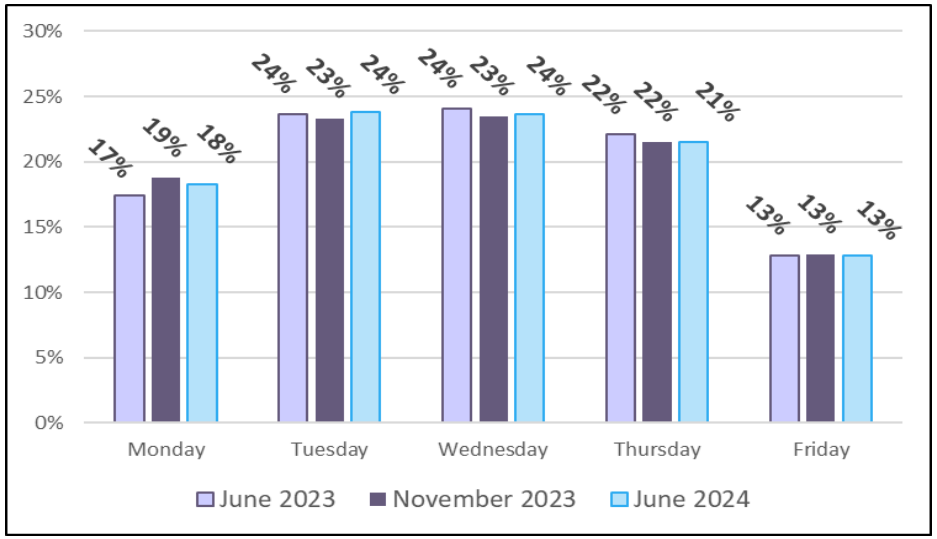
Bus – NY Interstate



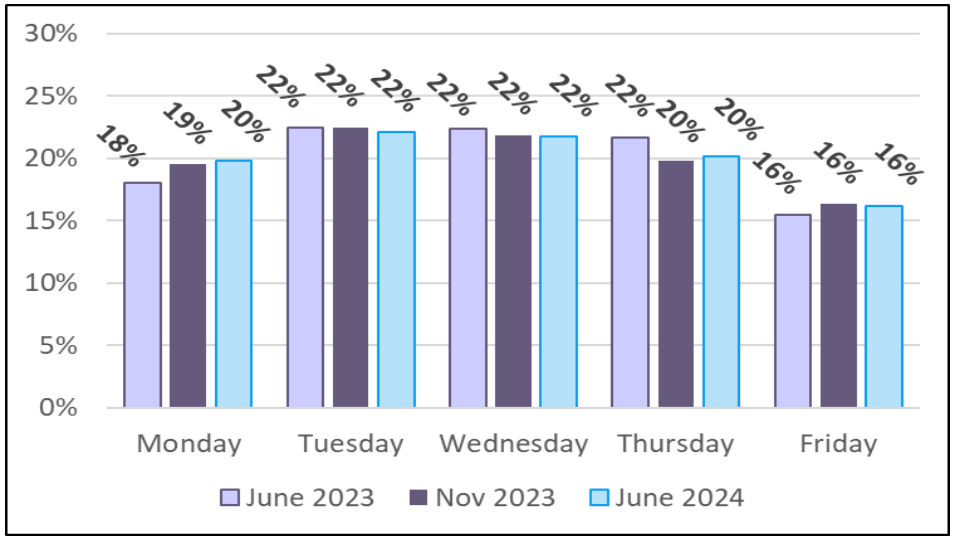
Bus – North Jersey Local, South Jersey & Contract



Rail



Light Rail



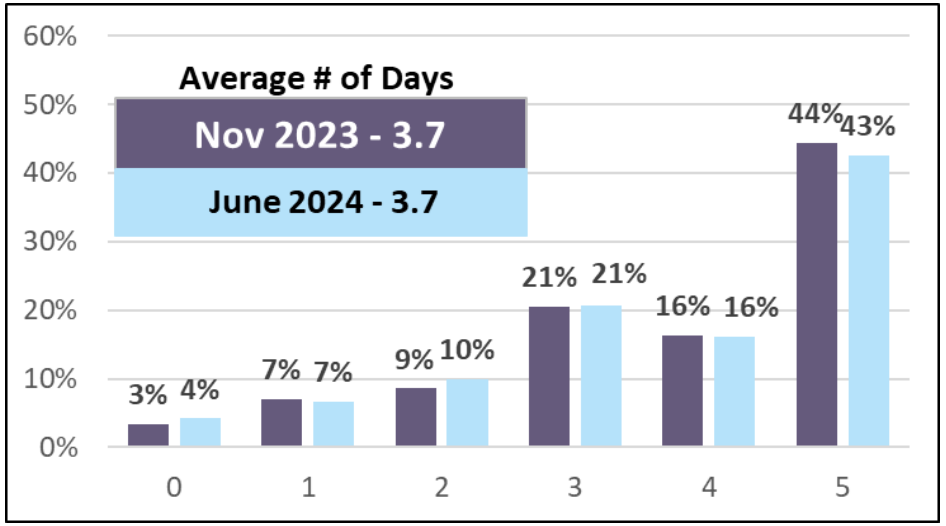
- The days of the week that customers typically ride NJ TRANSIT travel to their office/worksite has remained consistent for the last 3 surveys.

TRANSIT

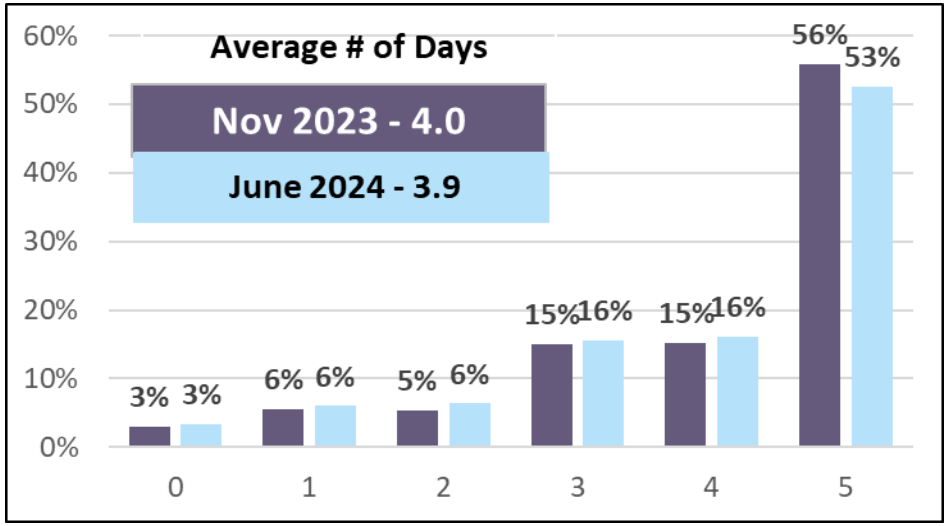
COVID-Related Findings
In the last 7 days, how many weekdays did you travel to your office/worksite?

Customer Satisfaction Survey
Spring 2024

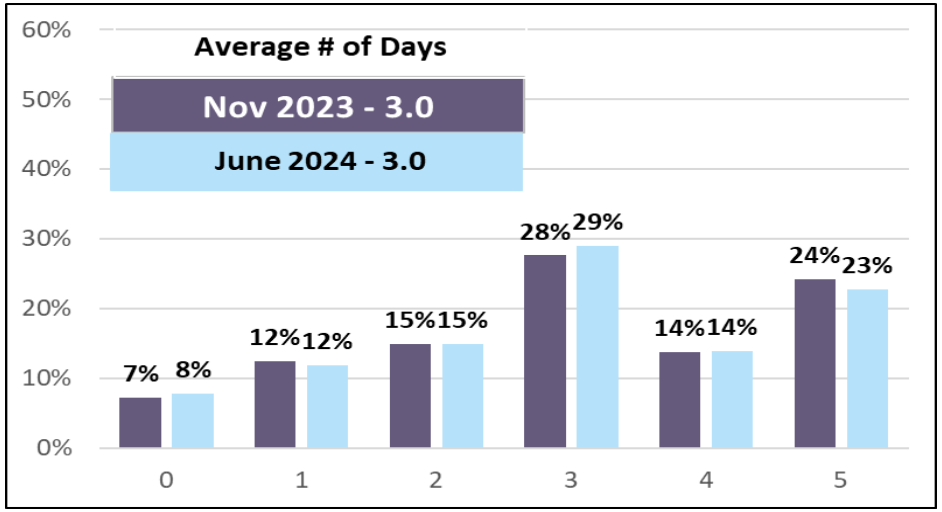
Bus – NY Interstate



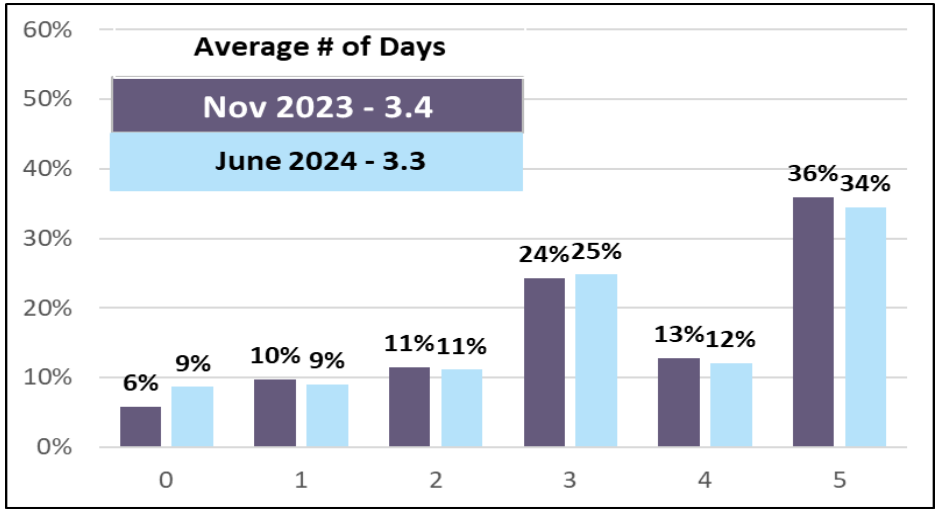
Bus – North Jersey Local, South Jersey & Contract



Rail



Light Rail



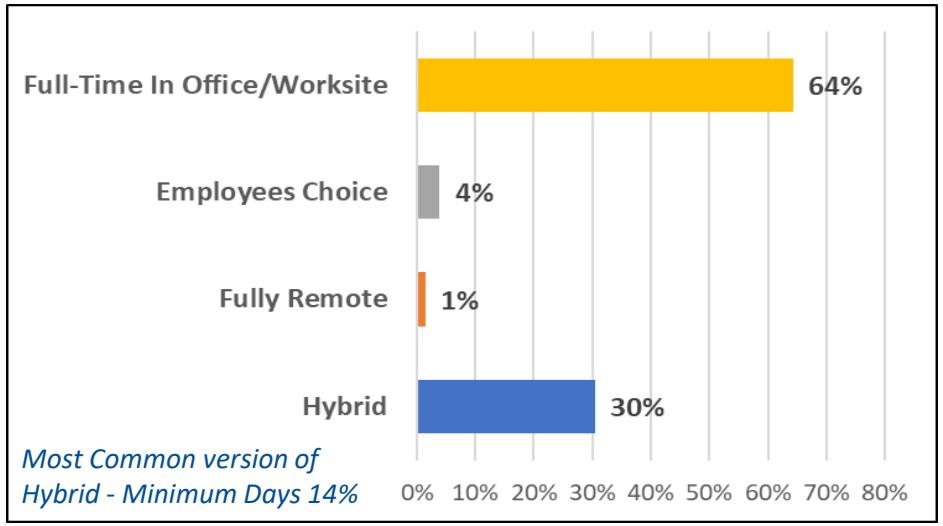
- The number of weekdays customers are traveling to their office/worksite are also consistent with only small variations in the past two surveys.

TRANSIT

COVID-Related Findings
Your Company's Current Office/Worksite Attendance Policy

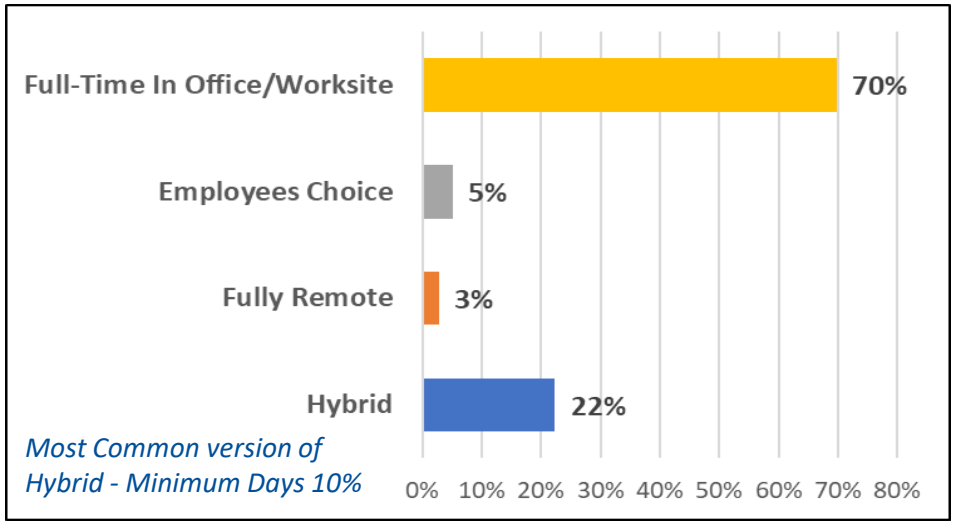
Customer Satisfaction Survey
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Bus – NY Interstate



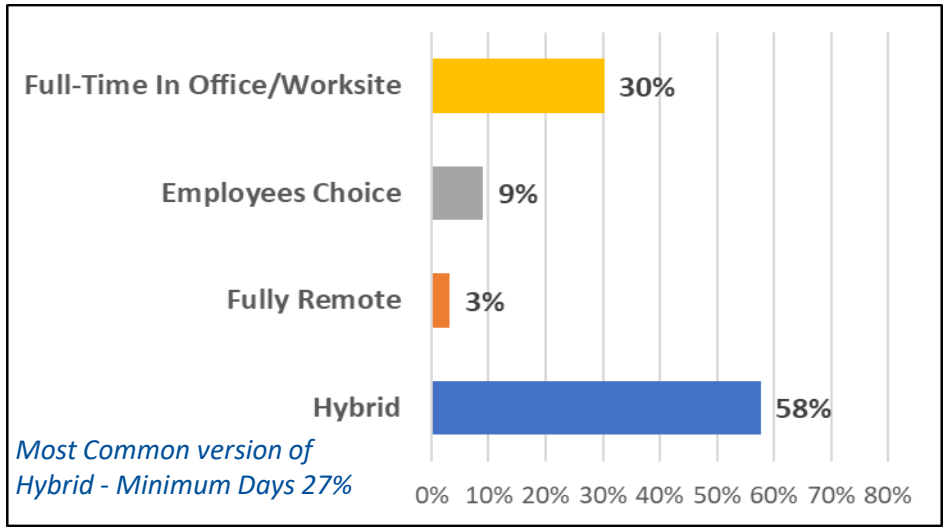
Most Common version of Hybrid - Minimum Days 14%

Bus – North Jersey Local, South Jersey & Contract



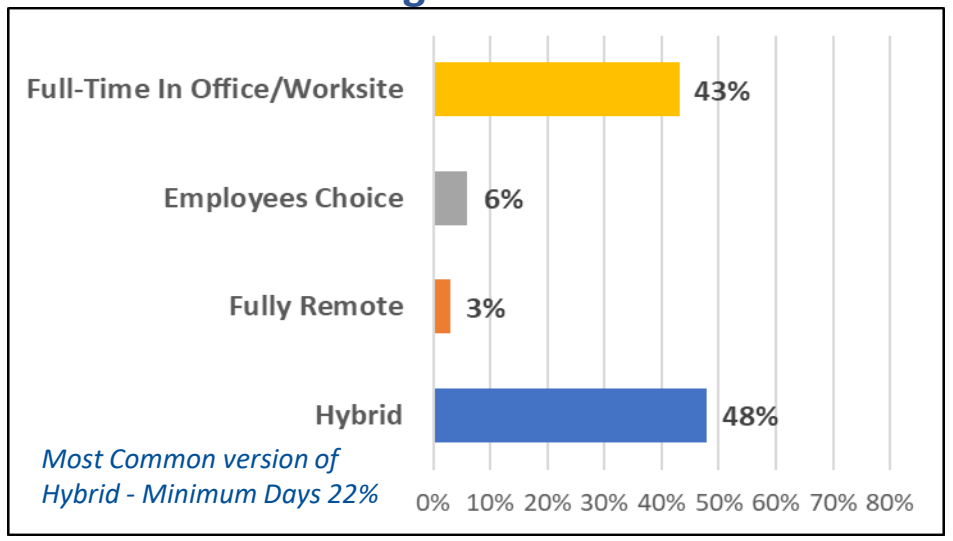
Most Common version of Hybrid - Minimum Days 10%

Rail



Most Common version of Hybrid - Minimum Days 27%

Light Rail



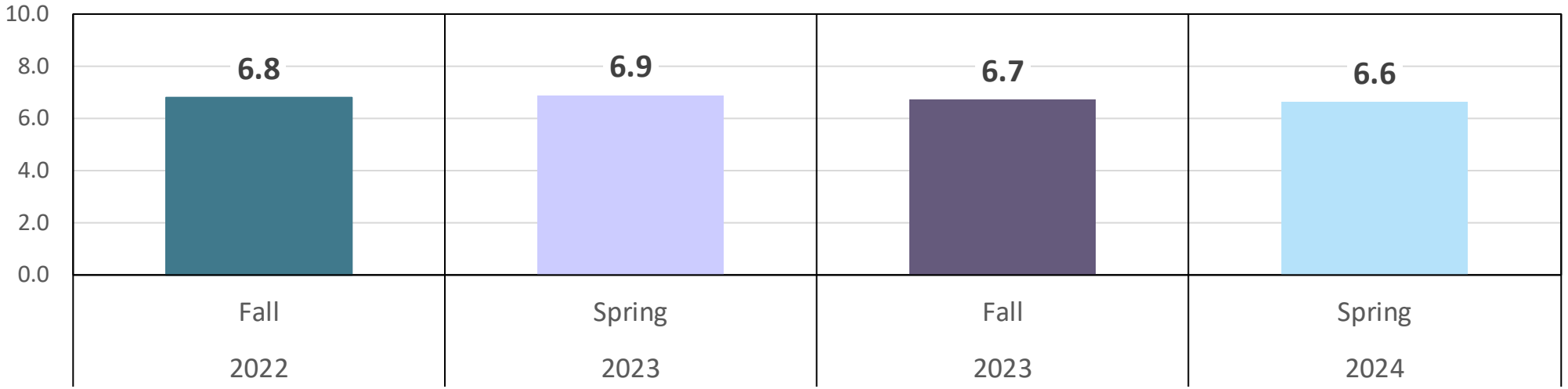
Most Common version of Hybrid - Minimum Days 22%

- Full time in office has the highest percentage for Bus
- Hybrid is highest for Rail and Lt Rail
- Minimum Days of the Week is the most common hybrid work policy

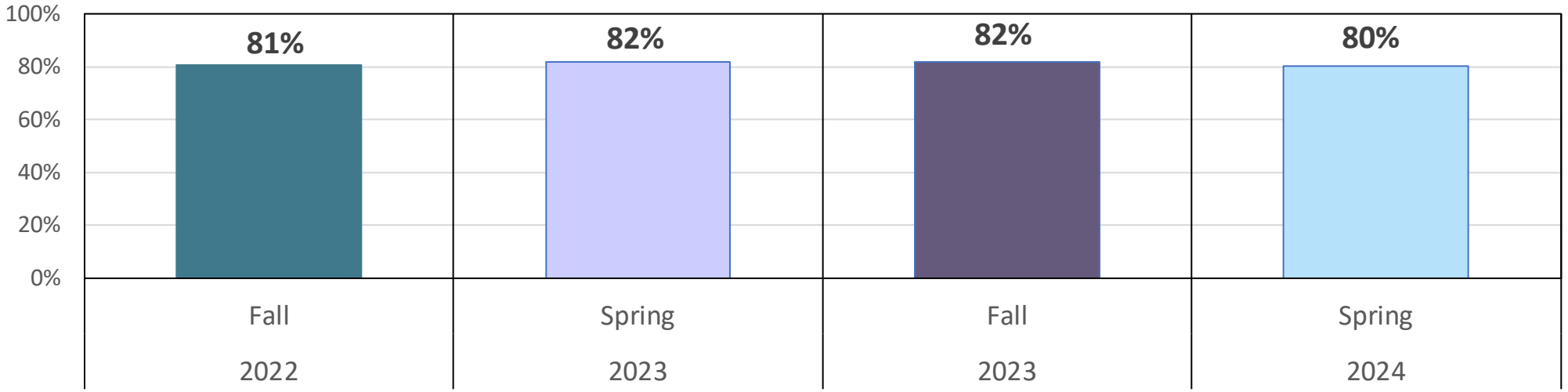
NJ TRANSIT

System-Wide Results

OVERALL SATISFACTION WITH NJ TRANSIT SCORE



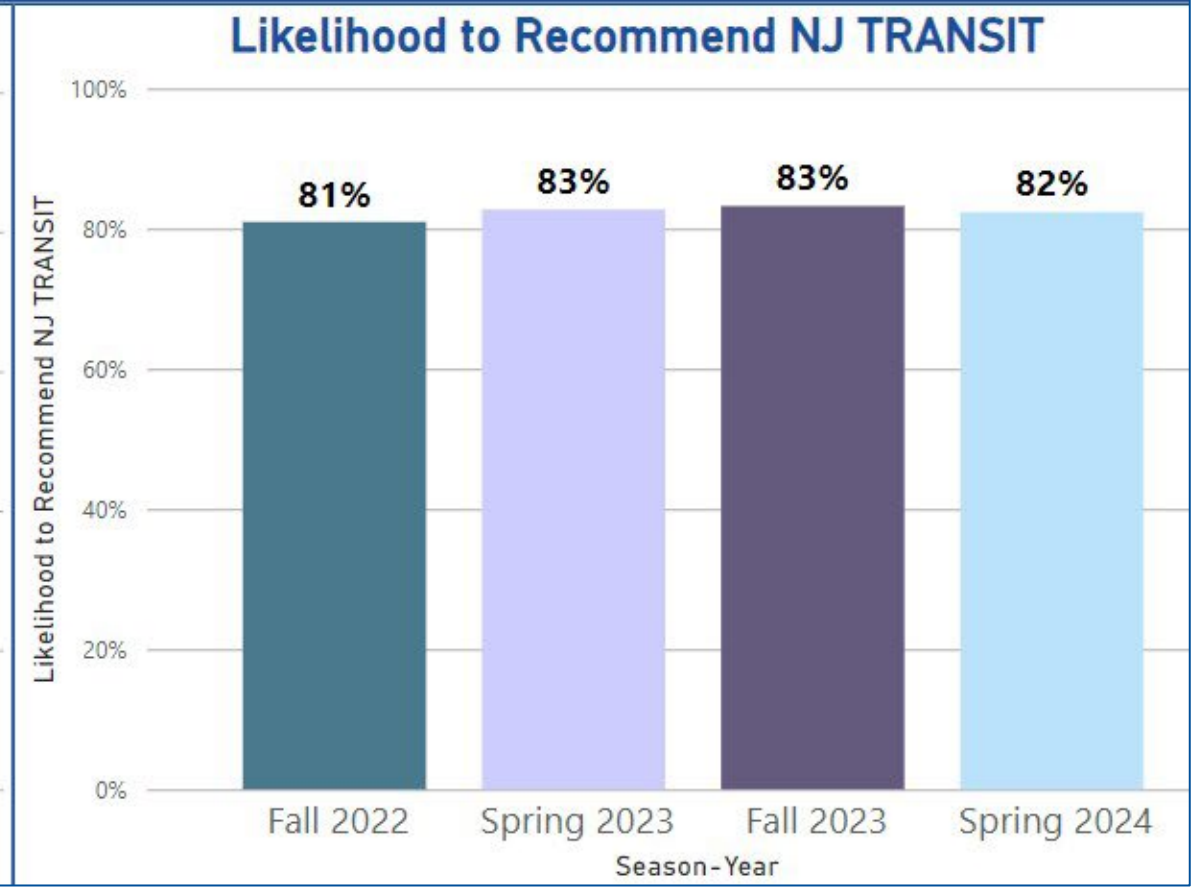
LIKELIHOOD TO RECOMMEND NJ TRANSIT



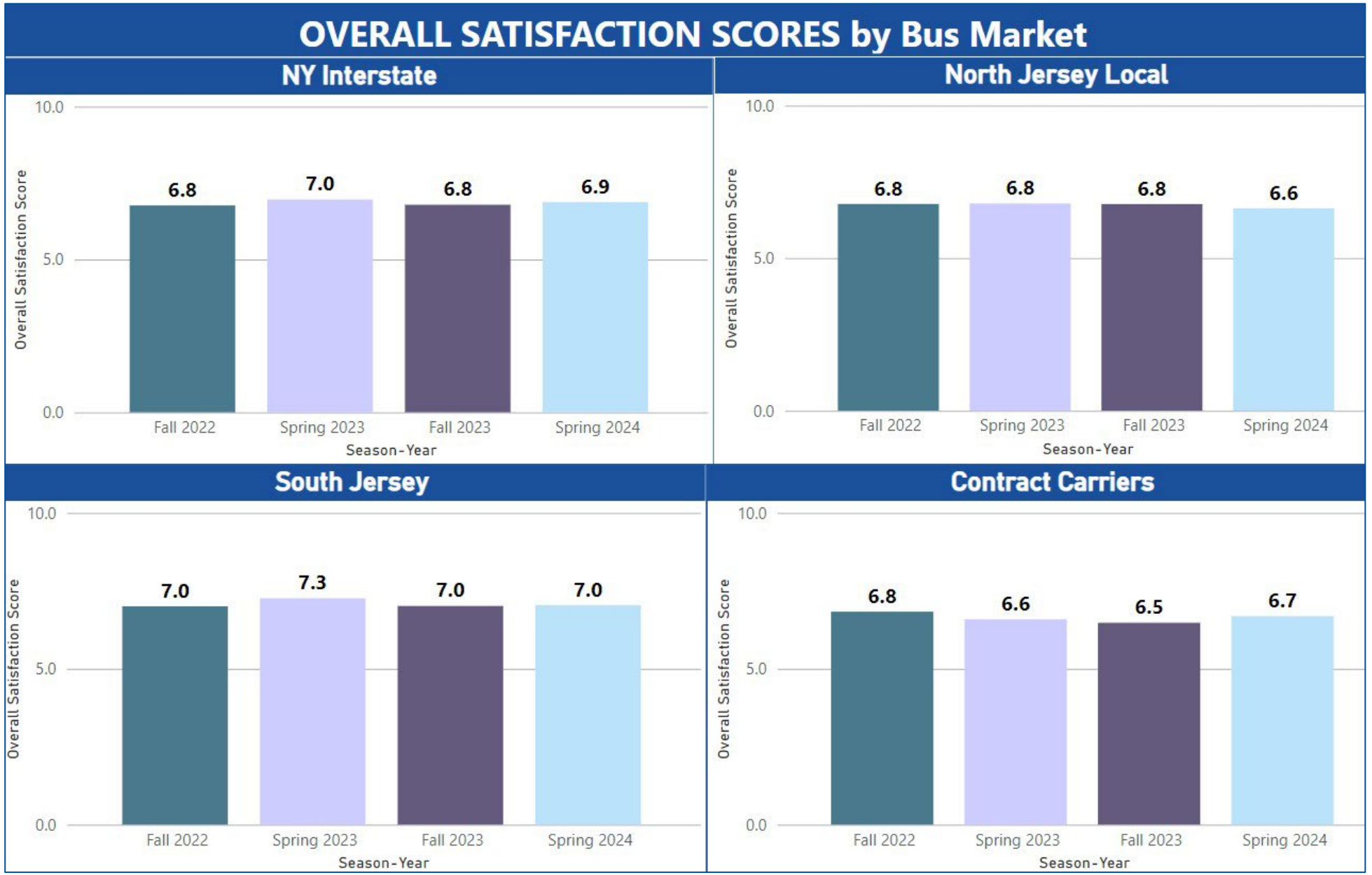
TRANSIT

Bus System





TRANSIT



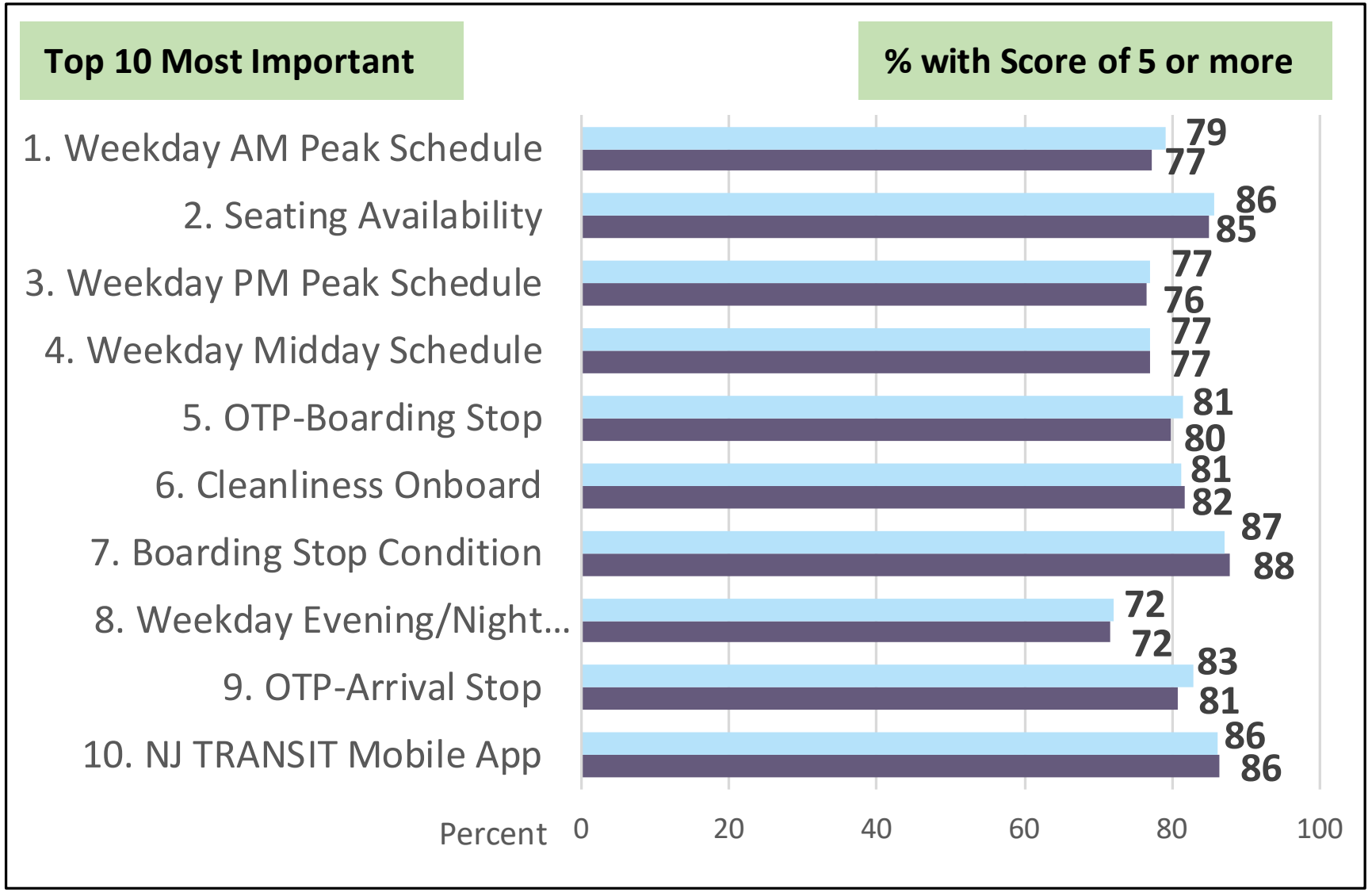
- The results shown here are from the last four surveys.
- The scores have remained generally consistent.

TRANSIT

Top 10 Most Important Service Traits for BUS

Customer Satisfaction Survey
Spring 2024

Bus System

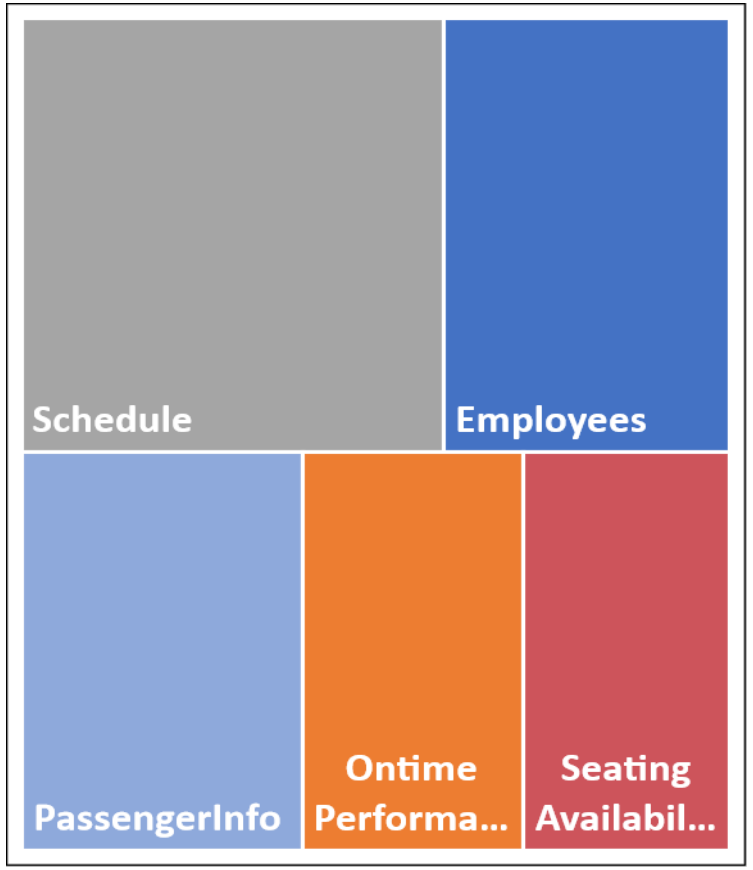


NJ TRANSIT

Top Topic Areas of BUS Comments

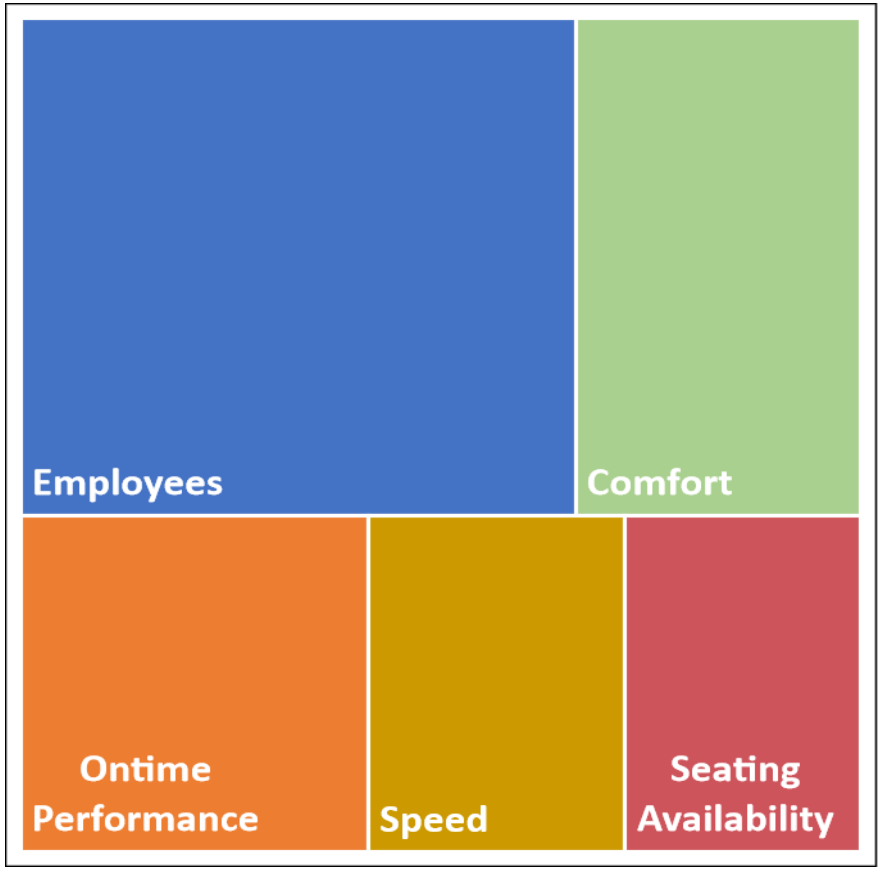
Customer Satisfaction Survey
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What is one thing we can do to **IMPROVE** your travel experience?



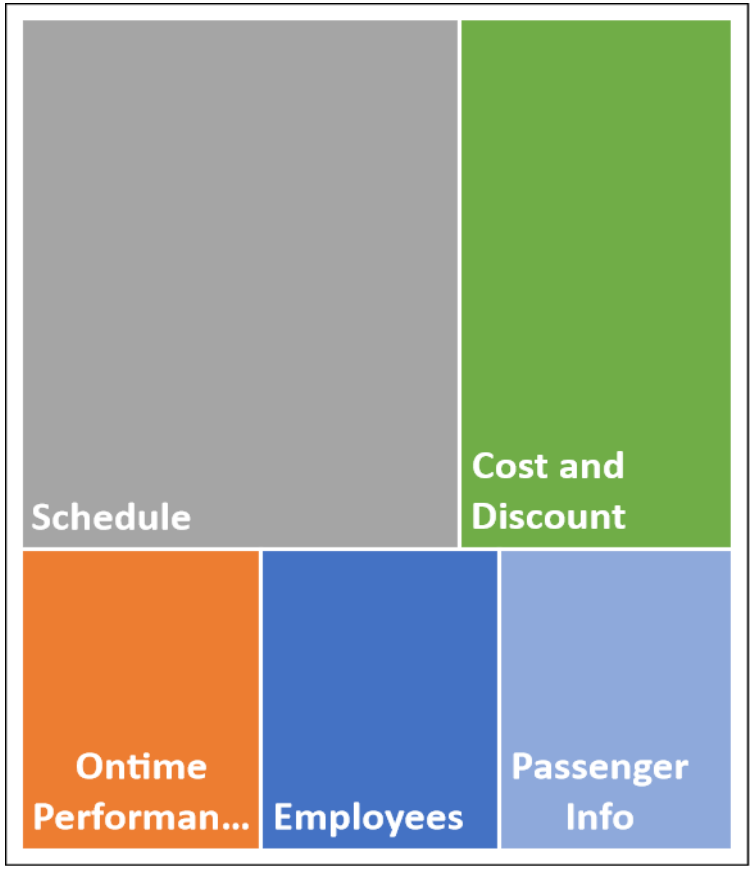
10,589 "Improve" Comments

What is one thing that you **LIKED** about your trip on NJ TRANSIT?



10,193 "Liked" Comments

What are the actions we could take to **ENCOURAGE** you to travel by NJ TRANSIT more frequently?



9,821 "Encourage" Comments

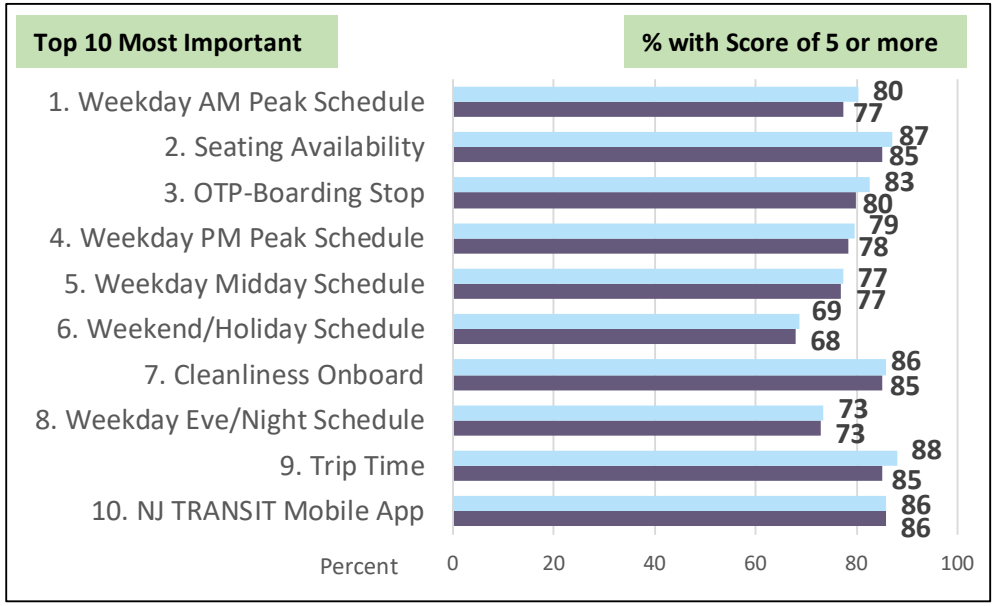
16,573 Bus Surveys

TRANSIT

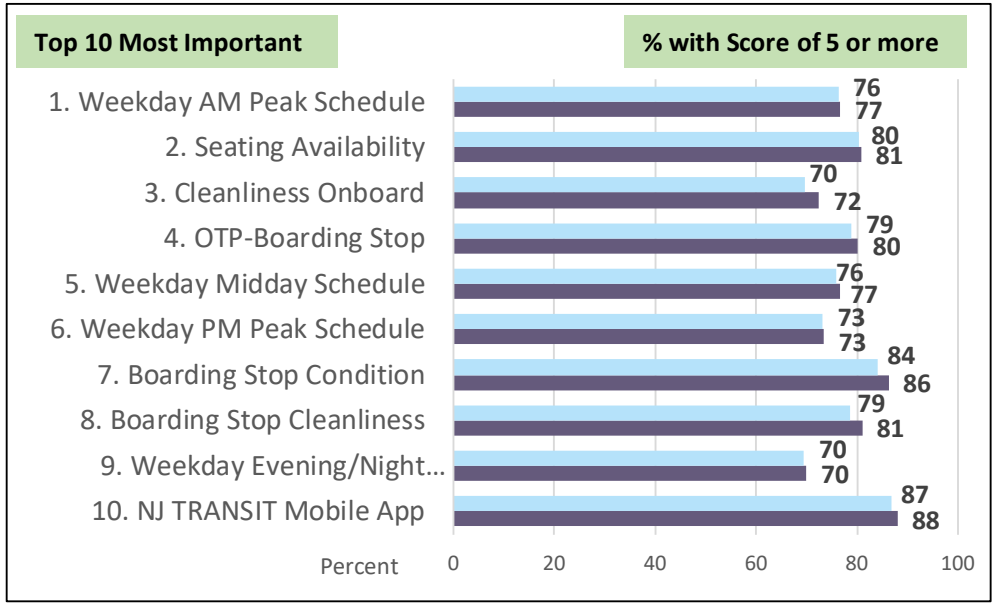
Top 10 Most Important Service Traits for BUS Customers by Bus Market and Score

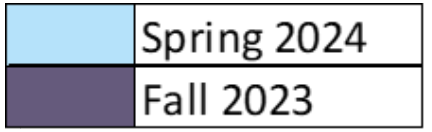
Customer Satisfaction Survey
Spring 2024

NY INTERSTATE

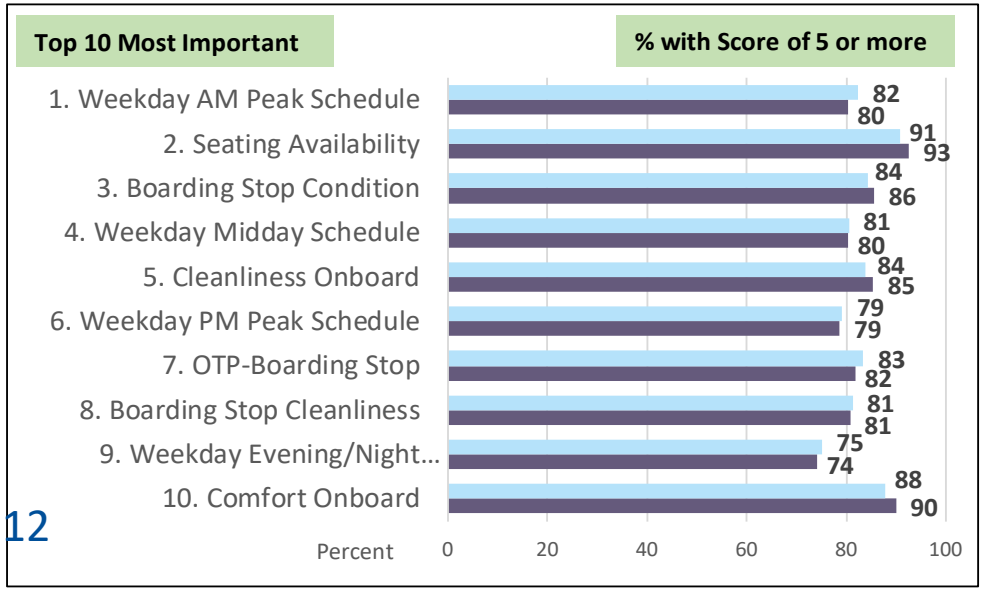


NORTH JERSEY LOCAL

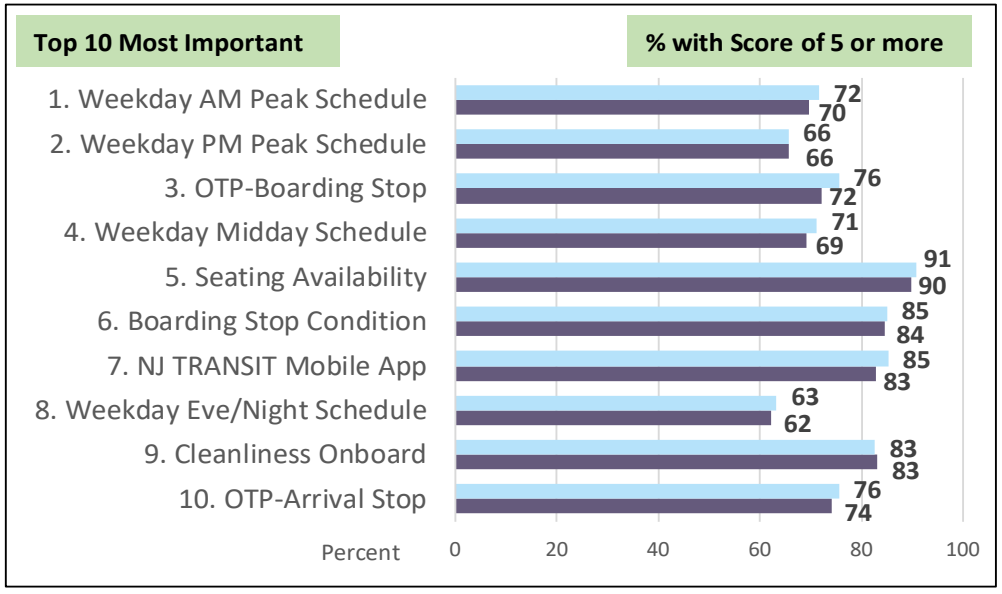




SOUTH JERSEY



CONTRACT CARRIERS



TRANSIT

Customer Satisfaction Survey

Bus Score Context

Scheduling

Scores related to Scheduling held relatively steady in all bus markets:

- Between November 2023 and June 2024, added 289 weekday trips across the system
- On the No. 119, all service daily now bypasses Journal Square to speed trips and improve OTP between 4:30 a.m. and 11 p.m.; moved route to Gate 210 at PABT to better handle volume and improve throughput
- Also, at PABT, articulated buses are now used on basement gates to improve capacity on overnight services out of Fairview Garage
- Made major service additions on the No. 24 and No. 31 due to continued ridership growth; both services are carrying over 100% more ridership than when NJT assumed the routes in October 2023
  - No. 24 carried 4,371 customers when Coach operated the service; now eclipses 9,000 regularly
  - No. 31 carried 1,800 customers when Coach operated the service; now averages 4,100 per weekday
- Extended numerous trips on the No. 87 to the Jersey City Heights from Journal Square to provide more service to the busy Heights area
- Added AM peak service on the No. 126 to reduce crowding

TRANSIT

Customer Satisfaction Survey

Bus Score Context

Facilities/Payment Options

Scores related to Facilities & Payment Options remained generally consistent across markets:

- Expanded the successful off-board fare collection pilot at PABT to additional routes early in June: 156 local, 159 local, 159 express, and 123 lines
- This pilot helps to speed boarding for customers at PABT and ultimately increases throughput at the terminal

Bus On-Board Conditions / Seating Availability

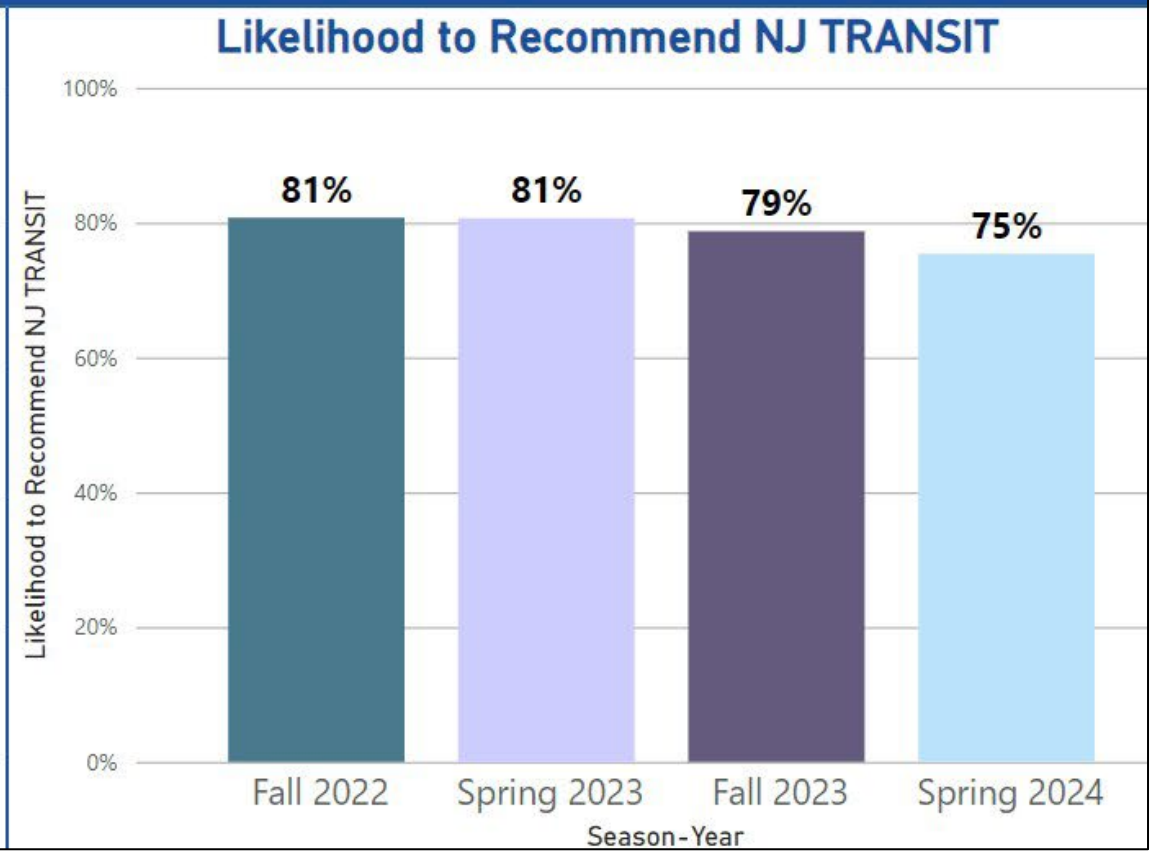
Scores pertaining to Bus On-Board Conditions and Seating Availability remained stable in most markets, with North Jersey scores falling slightly:

- Slight dip in North Jersey local scores may be attributed to the aging local bus fleet; the continued mid-life rehabilitation of 200 of our NABI 2012-2013 model year buses should help improve these scores, with 35 buses completed to date
- 23 of the order of 60 new articulated buses are now in service, which will help to improve seating availability

TRANSIT

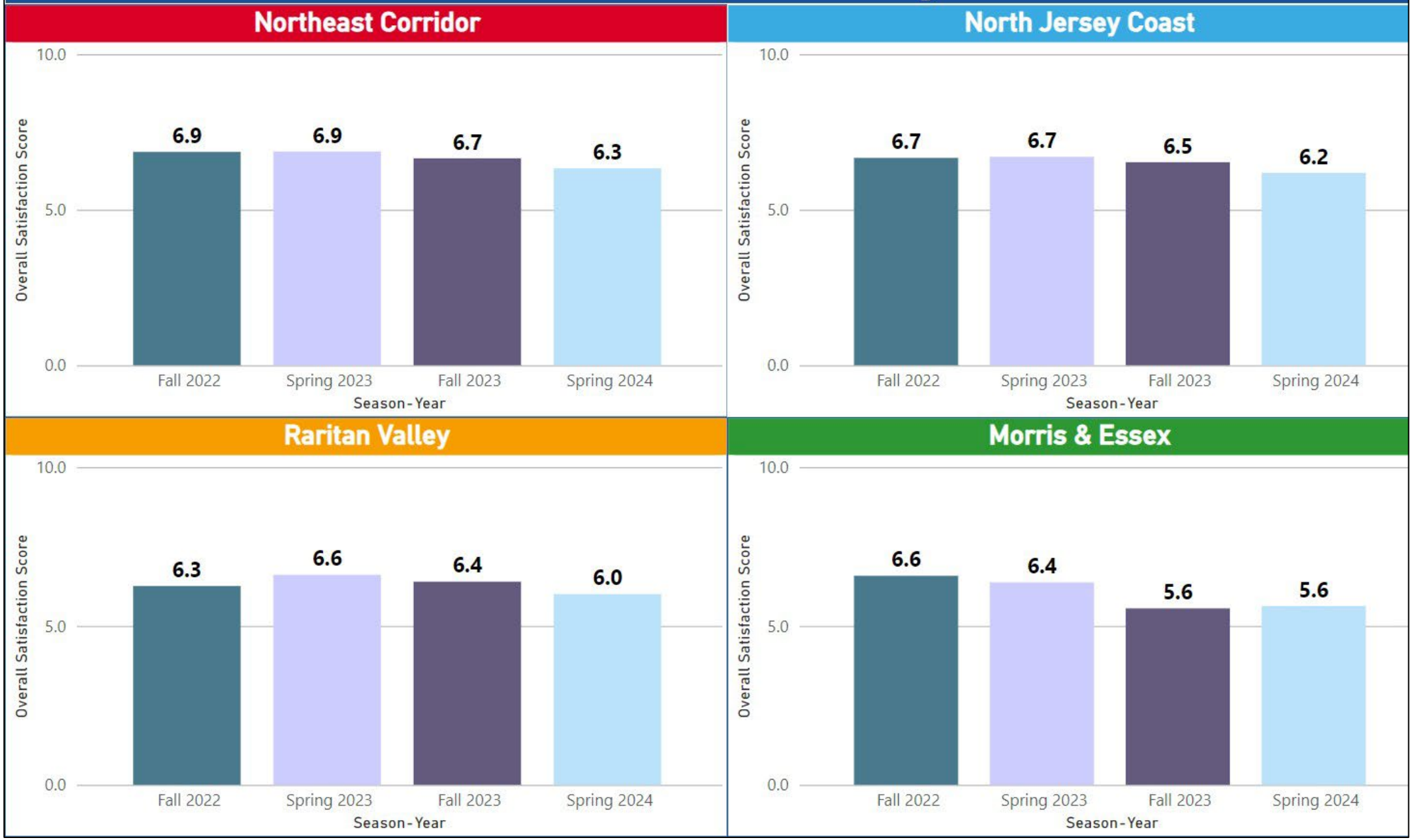
Rail System



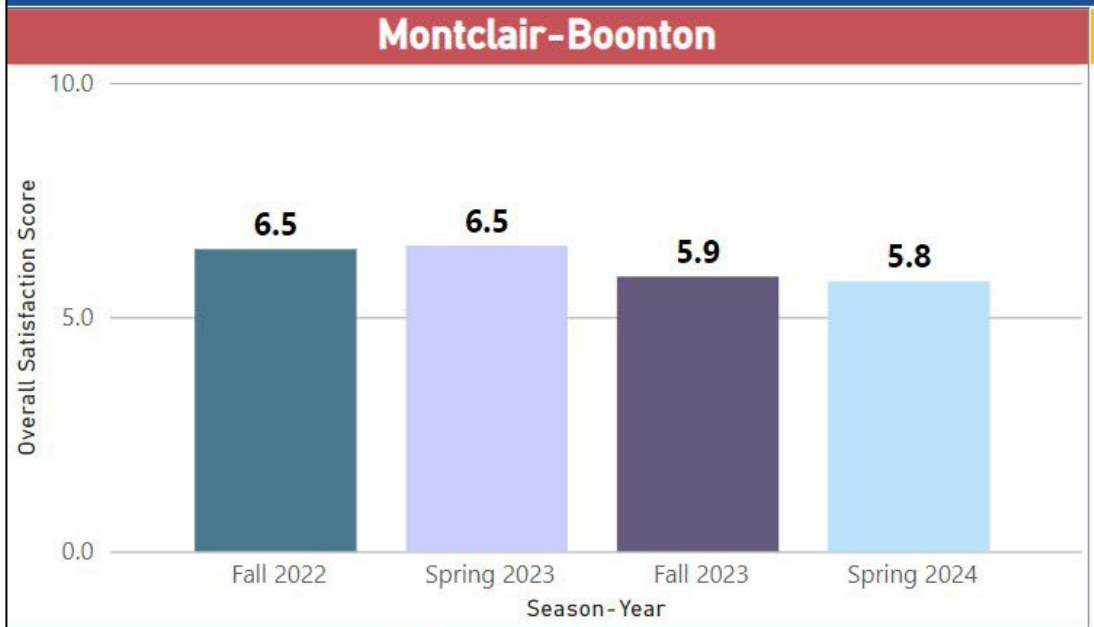


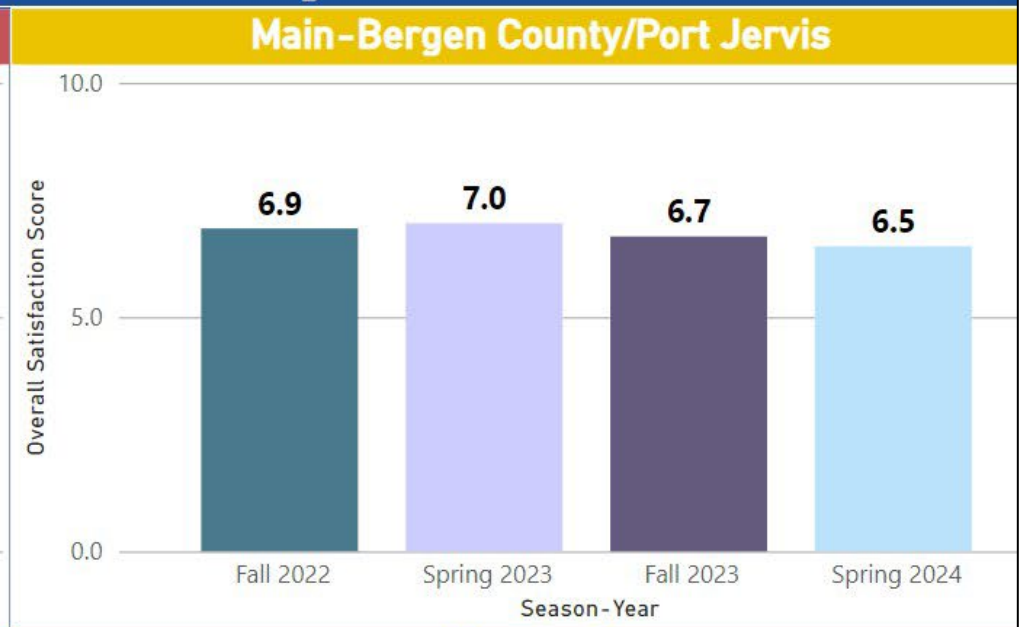
TRANSIT

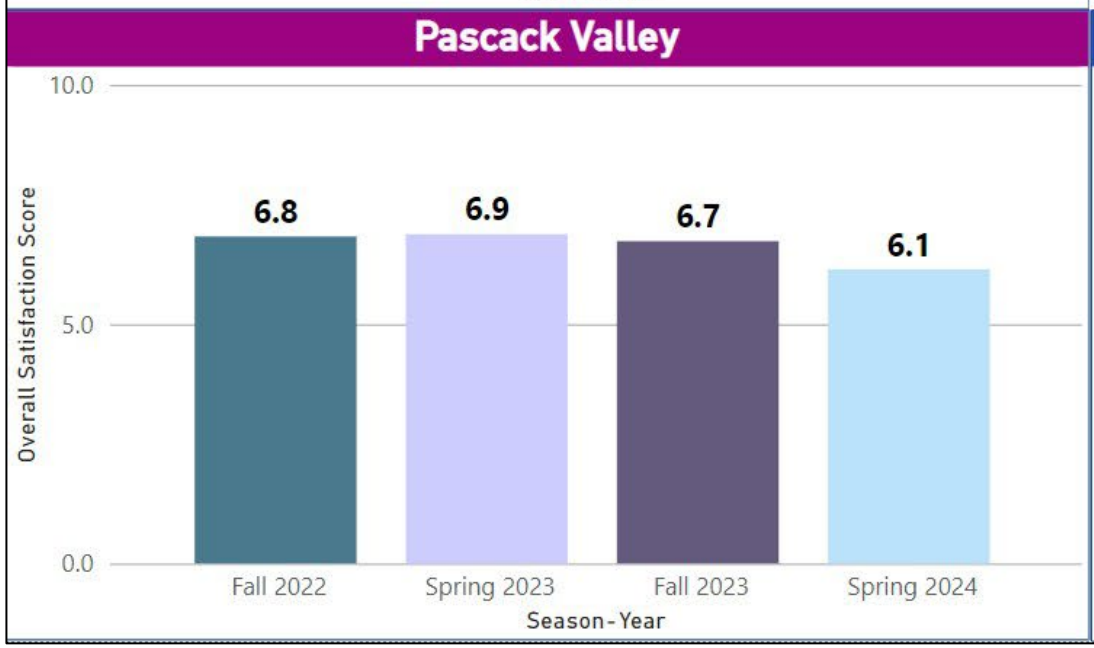
OVERALL SATISFACTION SCORES by Rail Line

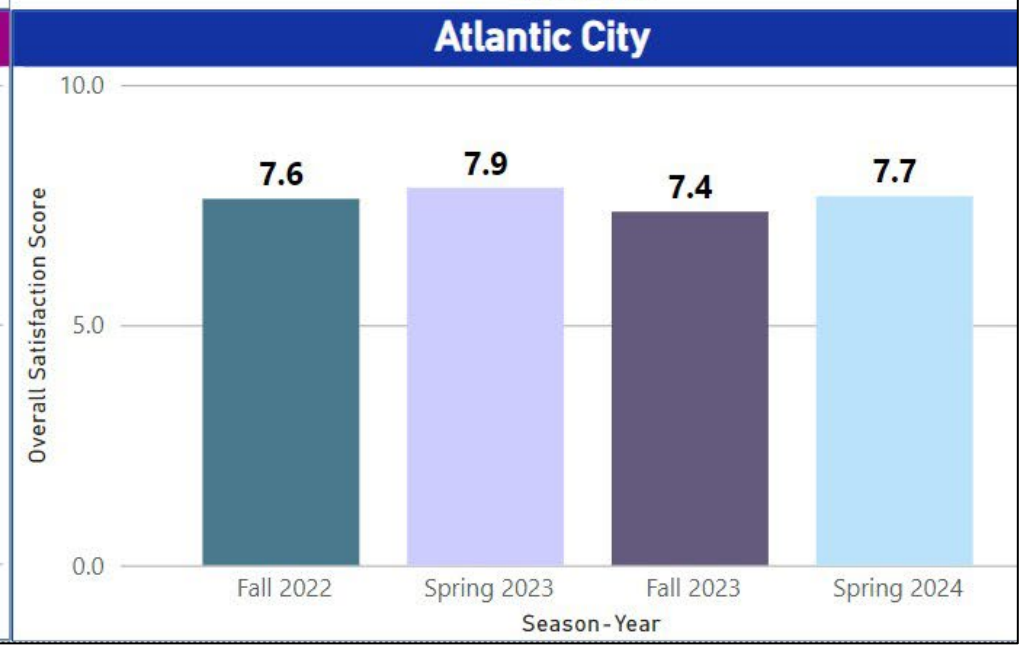


OVERALL SATISFACTION SCORES by Rail Line



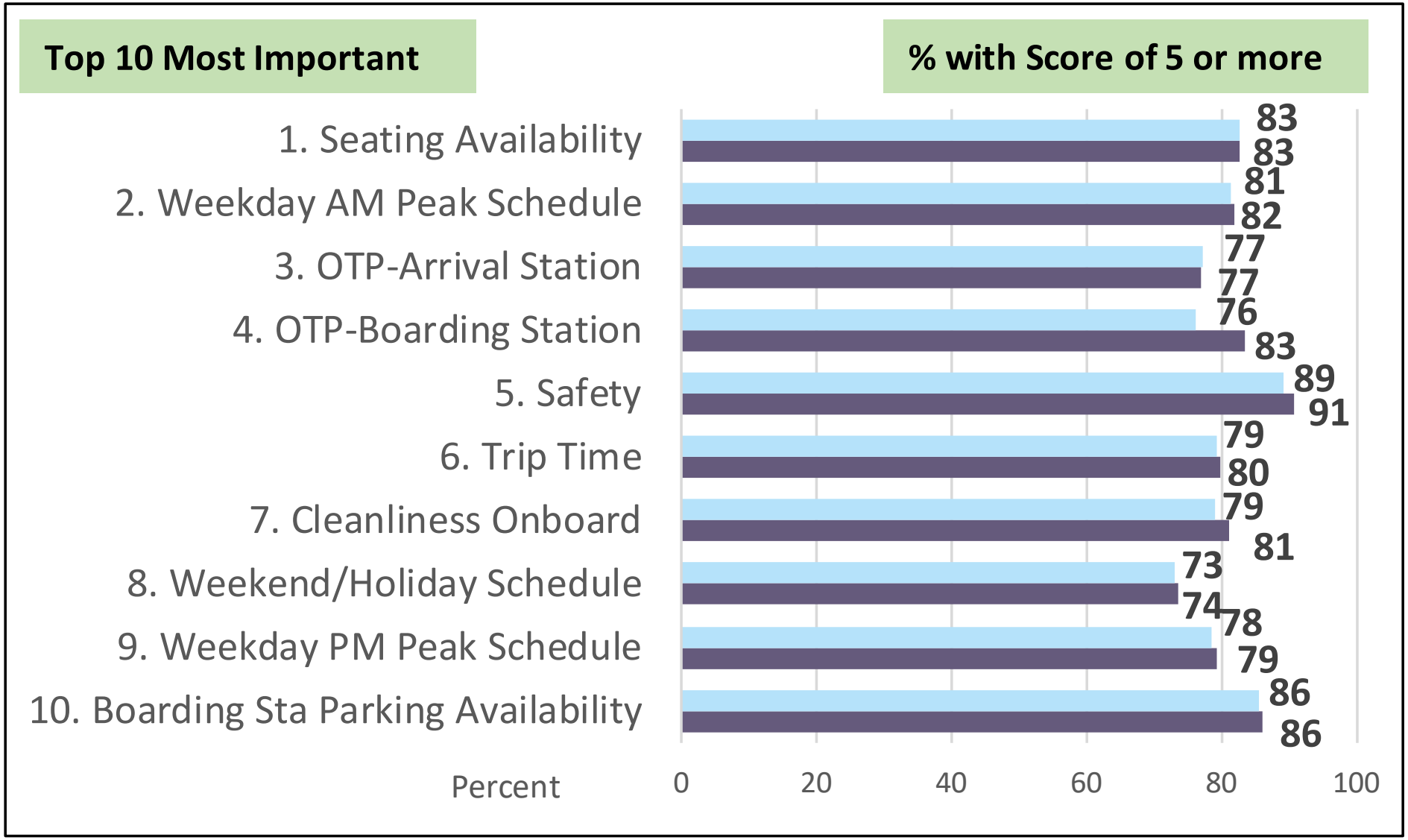






Top 10 Most Important Service Traits - RAIL System

Customer Satisfaction Survey
Spring 2024

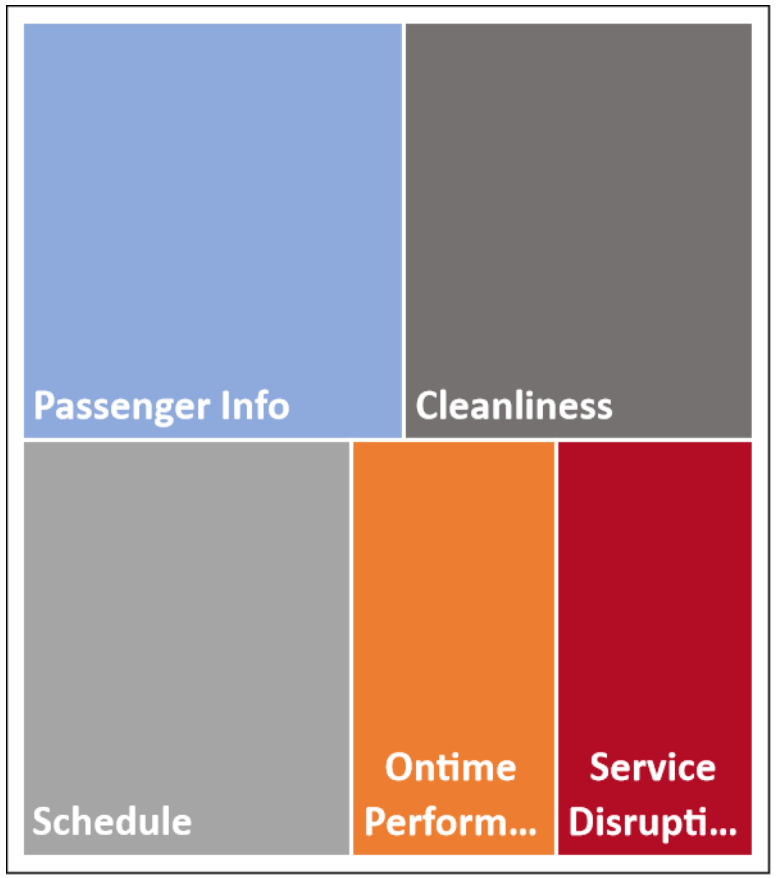


NJ TRANSIT

Top Topic Areas of RAIL Comments

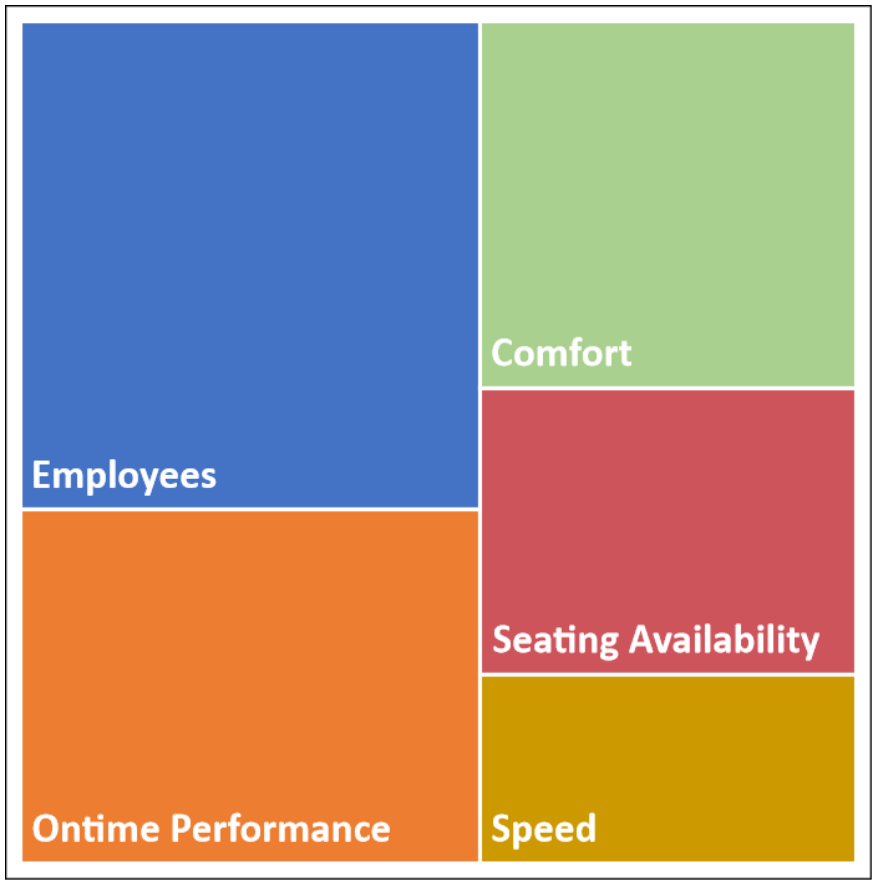
Customer Satisfaction Survey
Spring 2024

What is one thing we can do to **IMPROVE** your travel experience?



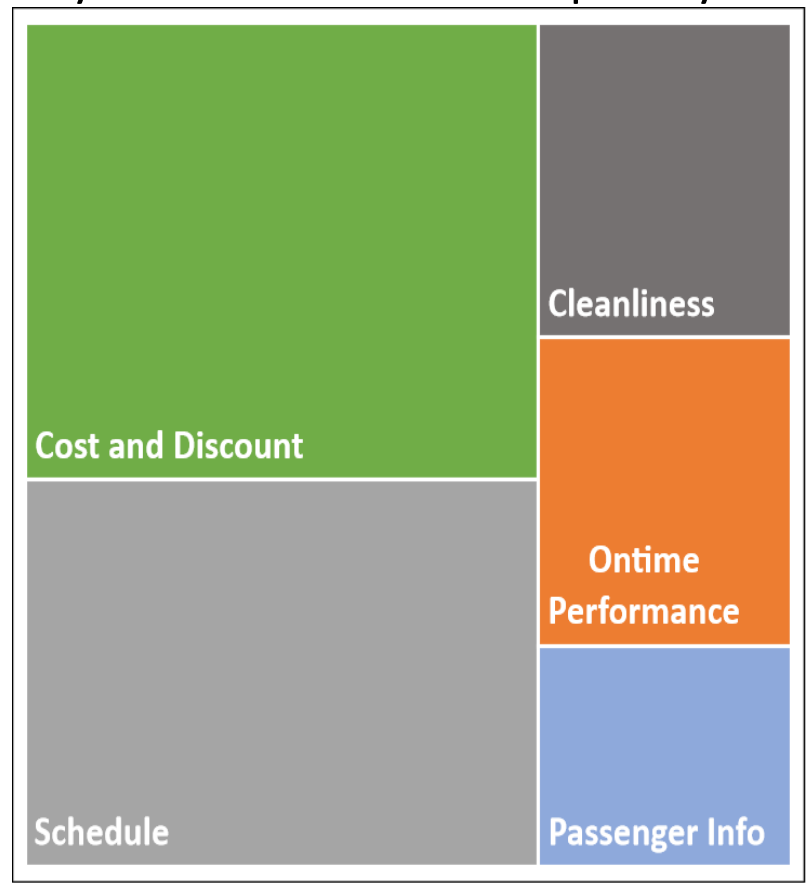
16,310 "Improve" Comments

What is one thing that you **LIKED** about your trip on NJ TRANSIT?



15,596 "Liked" Comments

What are the actions we could take to **ENCOURAGE** you to travel by NJ TRANSIT more frequently?



15,138 "Encourage" Comments

23,722 Rail Surveys

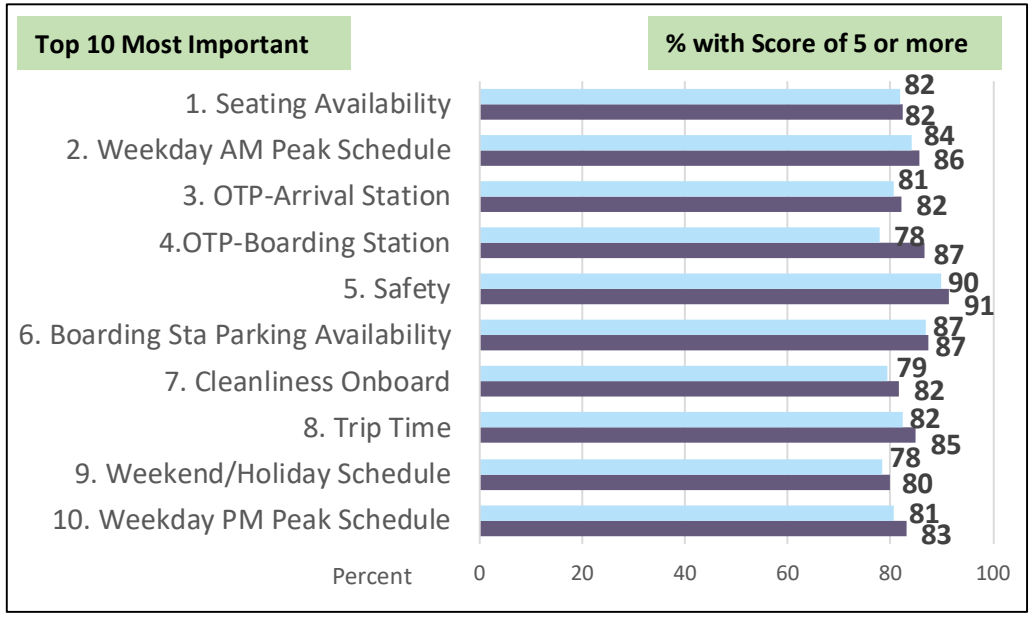
TRANSIT

Top 10 Most Important Service Traits for RAIL Customers by Rail Line and Score

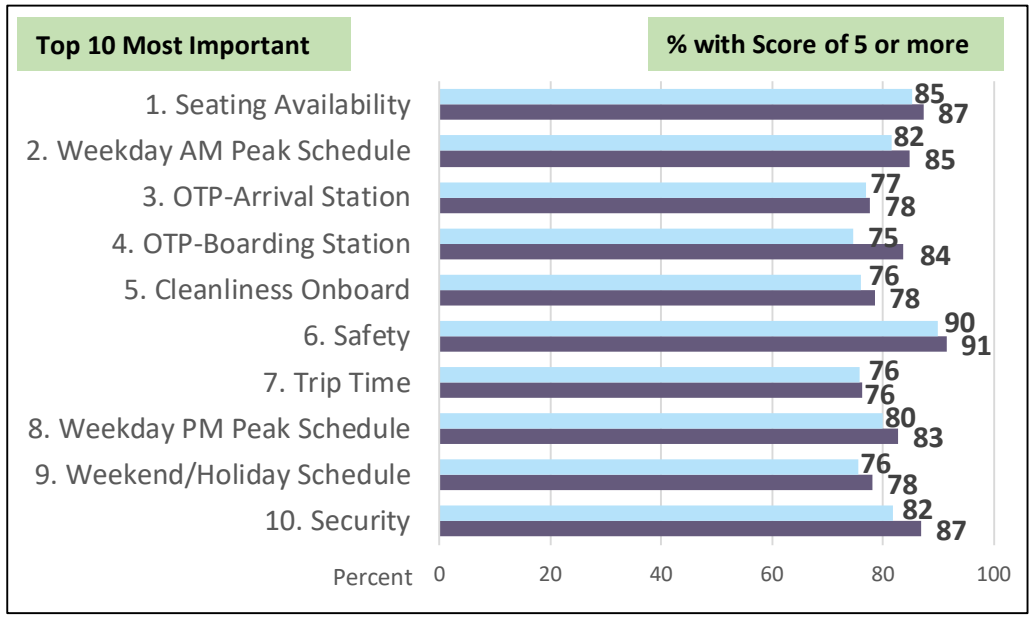
Customer Satisfaction Survey

Spring 2024

NORTHEAST CORRIDOR

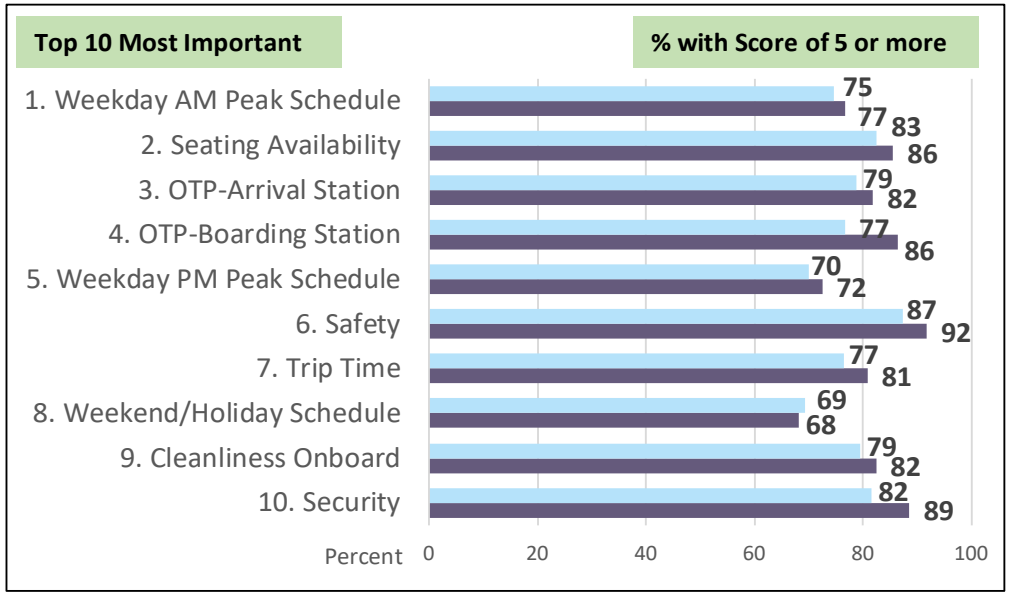


NORTH JERSEY COAST

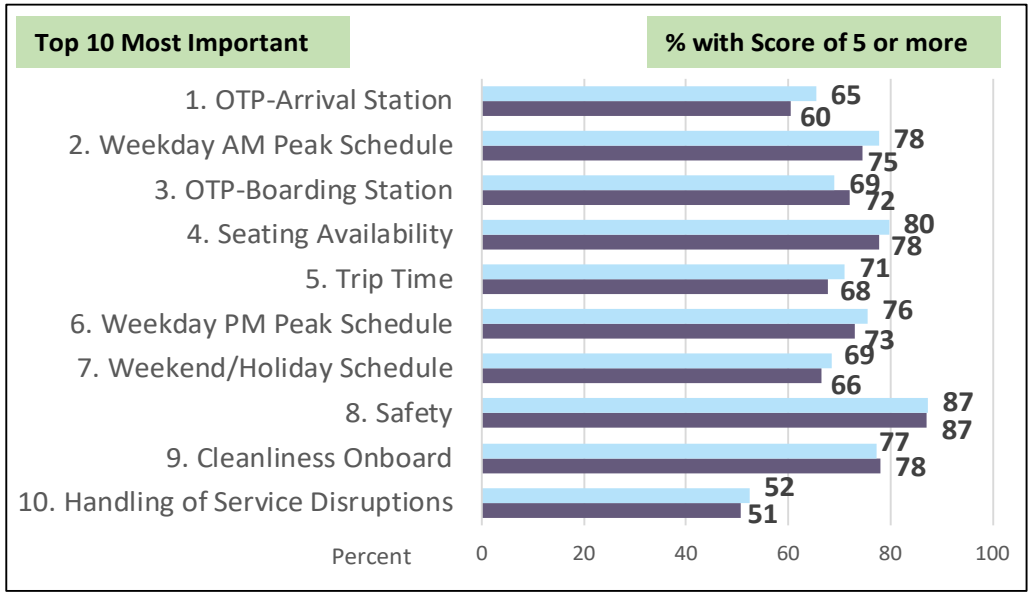




RARITAN VALLEY



MORRIS & ESSEX



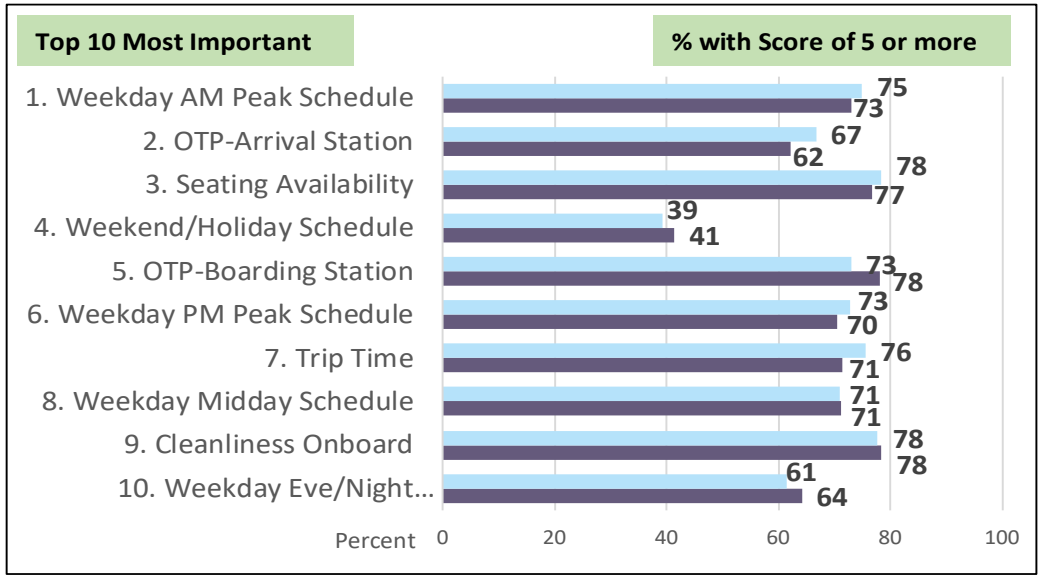
NJ TRANSIT

Top 10 Most Important Service Traits for RAIL Customers by Rail Line and Score

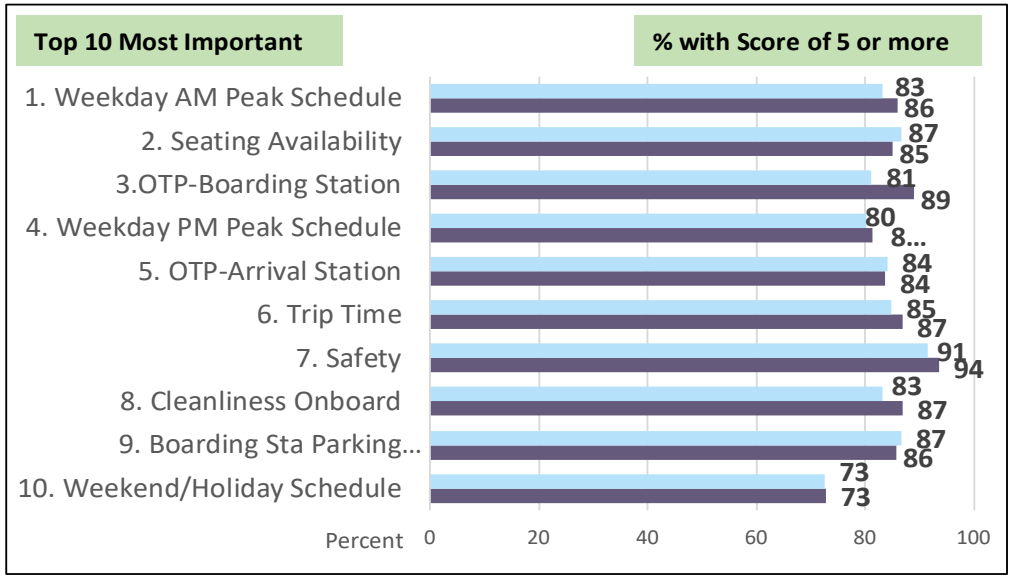
Customer Satisfaction Survey

Spring 2024

MONTCLAIR-BOONTON



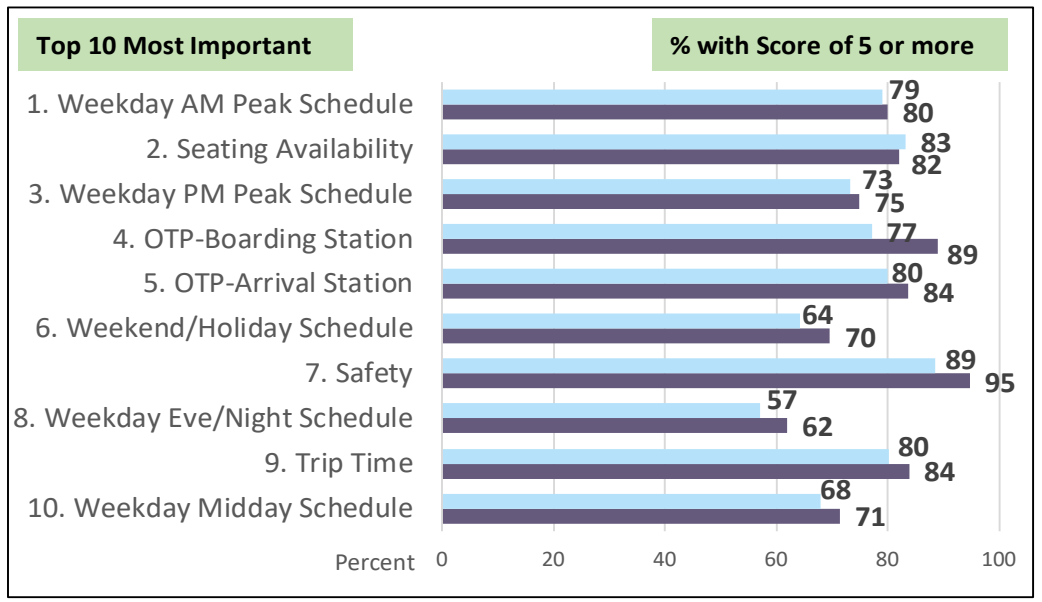
MAIN-BERGEN/PORT JERVIS



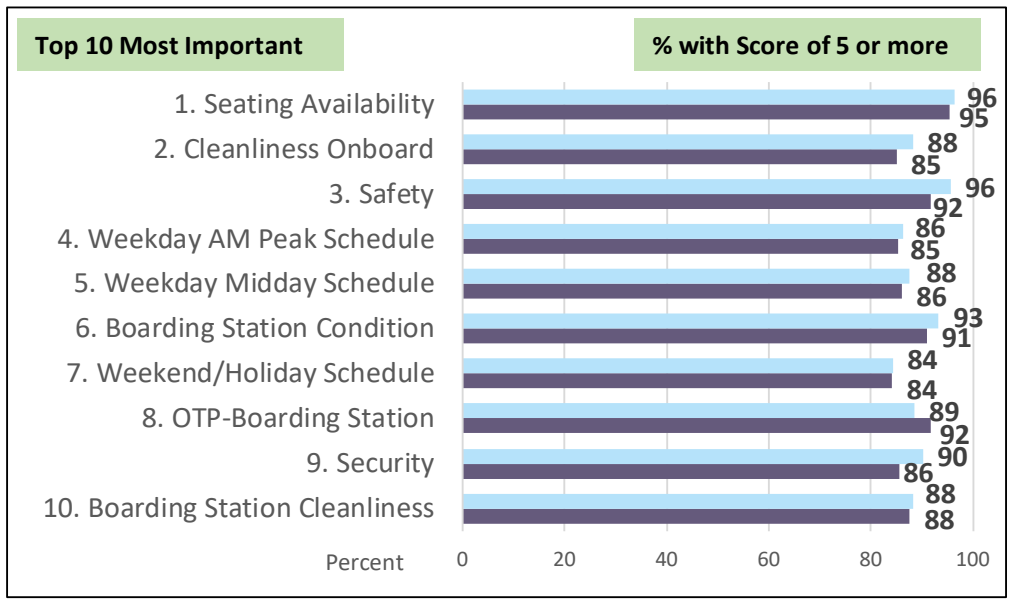
Spring 2024

Fall 2023

PASCACK VALLEY



ATLANTIC CITY RAIL LINE



TRANSIT

Customer Satisfaction Survey

Rail Score Context

Infrastructure updates

- New PID Cases as needed System-wide
- Hoboken Women's Room – full Remodel & Reconstruction
- North Elizabeth
  - Platform Stabilization
  - Track 4 ADA Ramp Repair & Track 4 temporary stairs to parking
- South Amboy
  - Entire station spruce up, bird netting, platform coating
  - Elevators 1,2,3 Floor Replacements
- Rahway new metal staircase-Stair set #10
- Absecon new elevator machine room doors
- Hamilton
  - New poles and LED lighting in the plaza
  - EB Elevator: Controller and Door Equipment Upgrade
- Upgraded Fire Sprinkler Pump Controller for Trenton Transit Center & Secaucus Junction Station
- Platform concrete repairs at NEC Stations (Metropark, Metuchen, New Brunswick, Rahway, Edison)
- Enhanced platform drainage at Metropark Station
- Ramsey Rt. 17 LED Lighting Upgrade
- Chatham LED Lighting Upgrade
- New Brunswick Track 1 Platform Stair Rebuild & Stair set Upgrade to LED
- Secaucus Emergency Wall Repair
- Union Station HVAC Upgrade
- Absecon Elevator Cab Interior and Floor Replacement

TRANSIT

Customer Satisfaction Survey

Rail Score Context

Infrastructure updates

- Newark Penn Station (NPS)
  - Escalators 10, 13, & 17 Control Upgrade
  - Elevator 42 Cab Interior Replacement
  - Escalator 35 Step Replacement
- Plainfield EB and WB Floor Replacements
- East Orange
  - EB Elevator Cab Ceiling/Lighting and Floor Replacement
  - EB and WB Elevator Door Sill Replacements
- Edison
  - EB and WB Elevator Door Sill Replacements
  - EB and WB Travelling Cable Replacements
  - Replacement stairs to Track 1 Platform
- South Orange EB and WB Elevator Door Sill Replacements

Service Planning

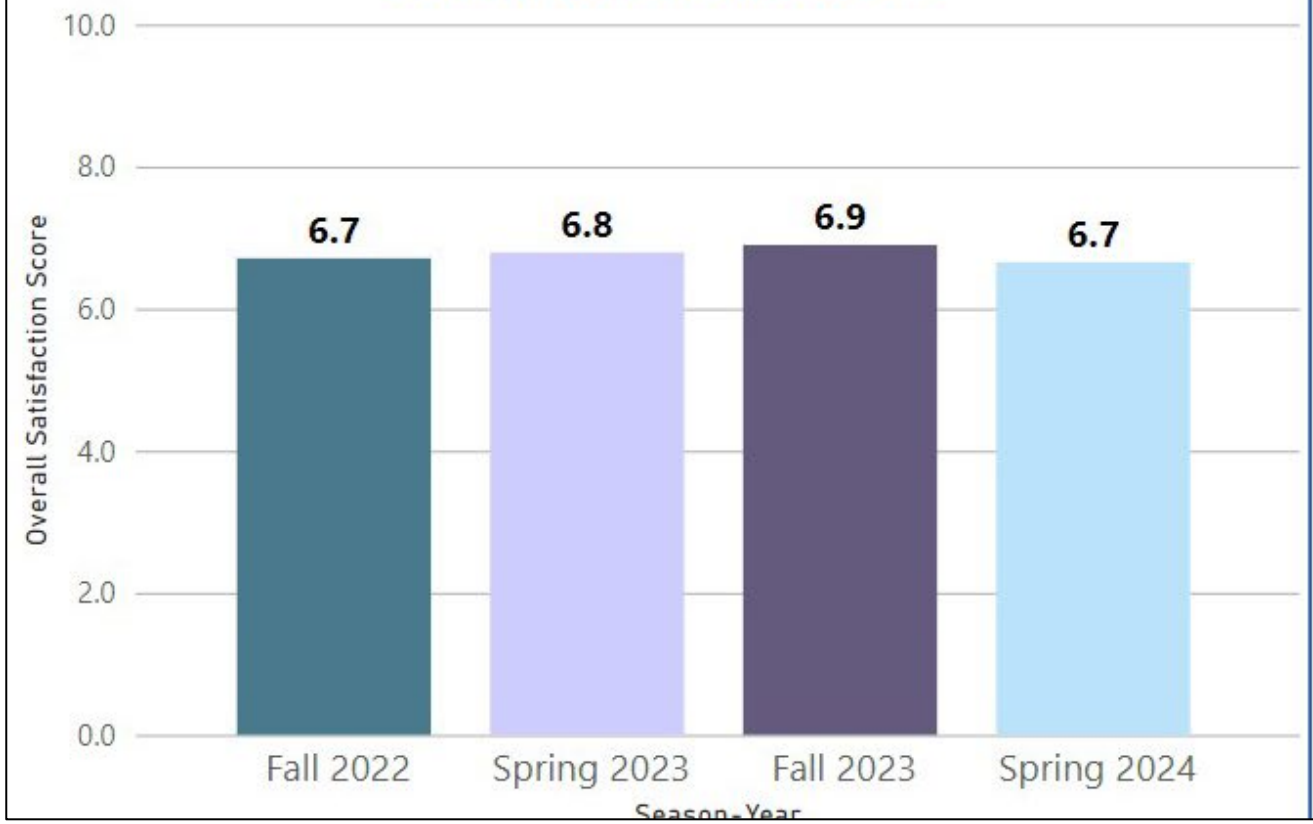
- Scores reflect coincident timing of May 19 schedule change with Amtrak catenary and infrastructure failures that began on May 21 and continued throughout the survey period
- Amtrak infrastructure issues reduced equipment availability resulting in many trains operating with fewer than required number of cars
- Adjustments to early morning NEC schedule Jersey Ave-Metropark due to completion of track repairs in County Yard, and seating availability on NJCL, both affected by operational and service issue

Mechanical

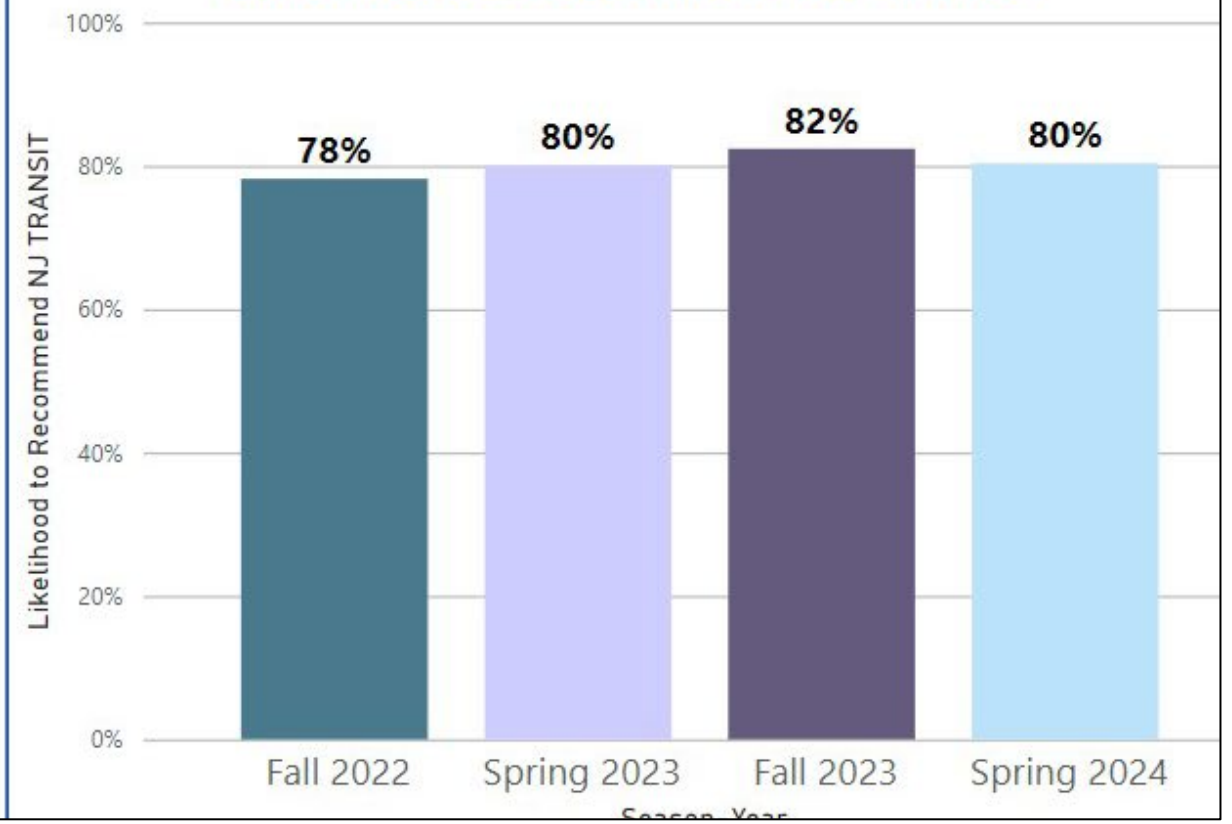
- Continuing efforts to improve interior cleanliness by having dedicated crews to perform E cleaning
- Expecting delivery of 400 to 600 new Multilevel windows and we will begin to change out once they arrive

Light Rail System

Overall Satisfaction Score



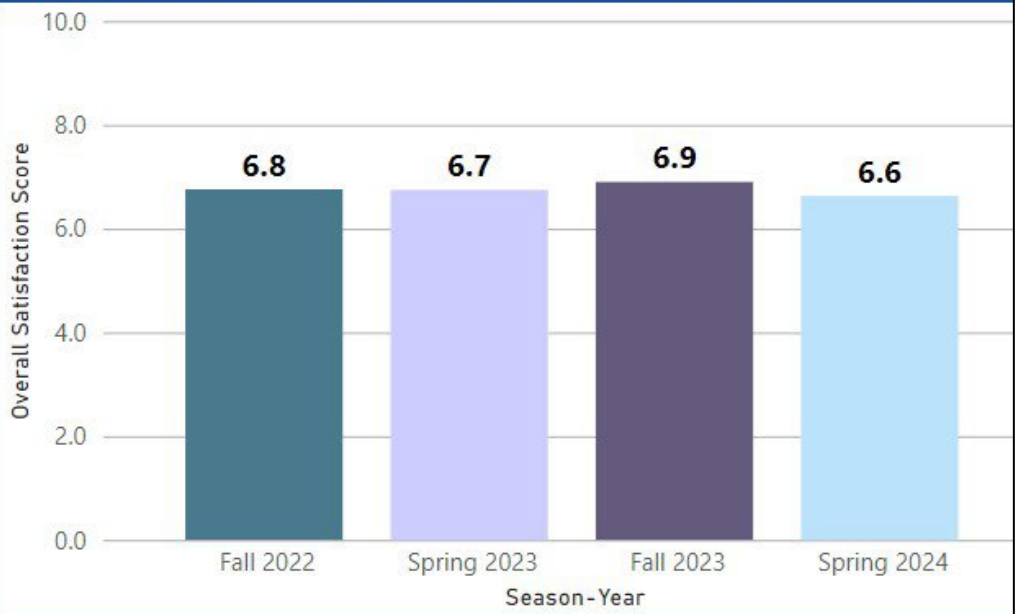
Likelihood to Recommend NJ TRANSIT



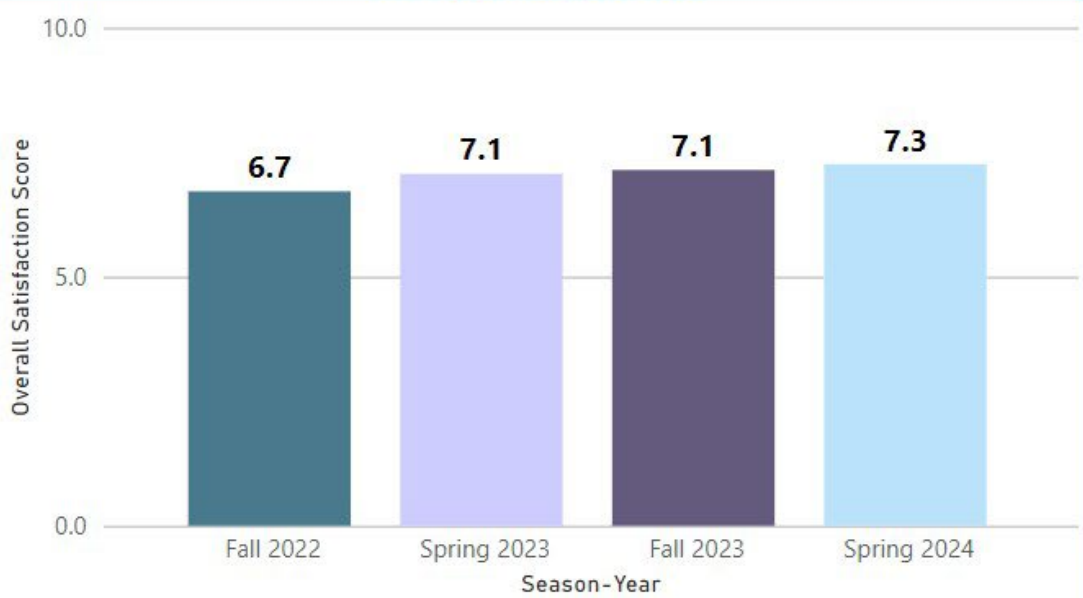
TRANSIT

OVERALL SATISFACTION SCORES by MARKET

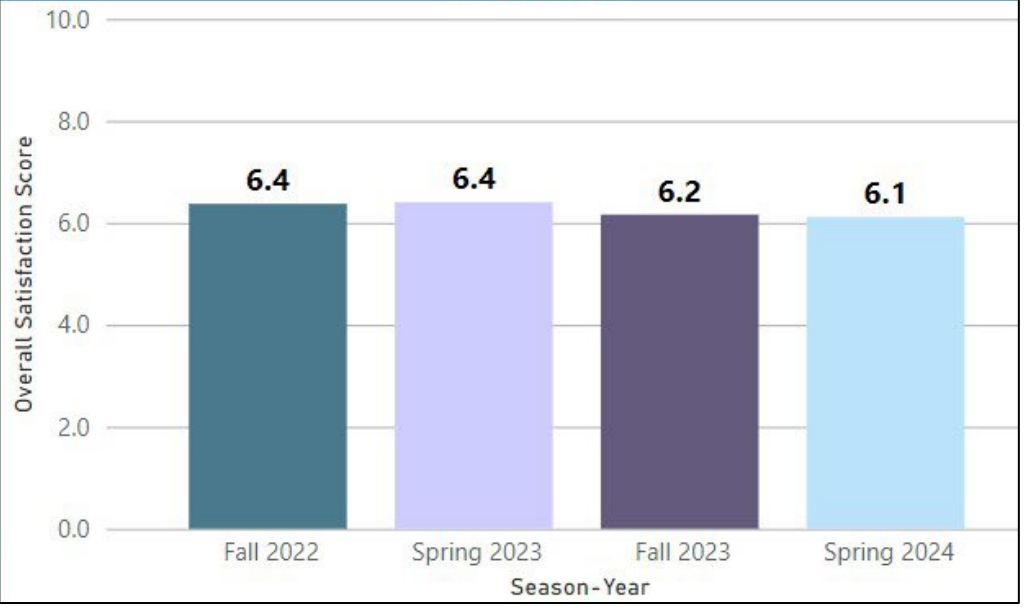
Hudson-Bergen Light Rail



Newark Light Rail



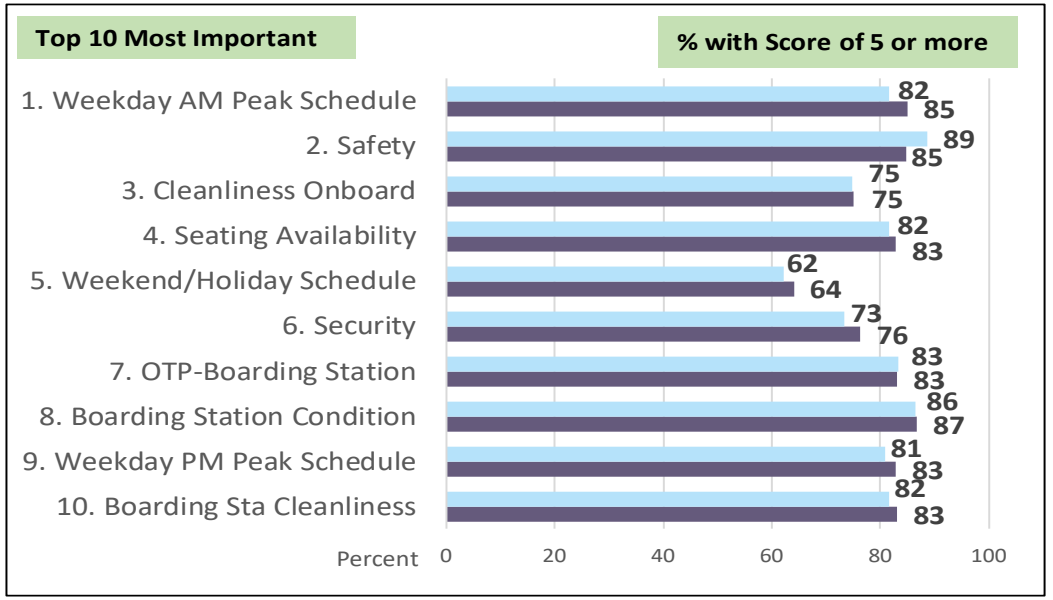
River LINE



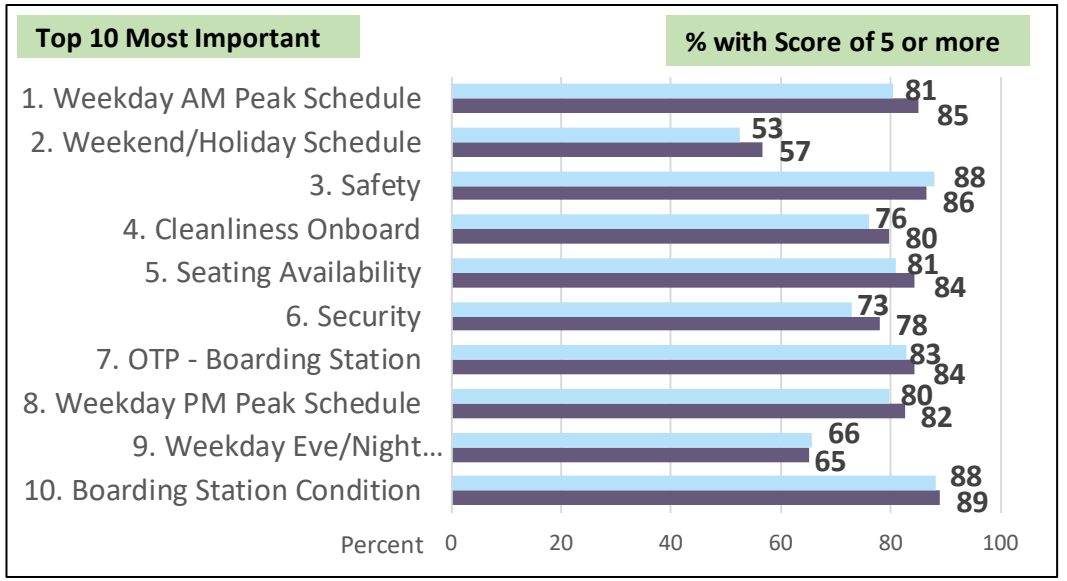
Top 10 Most Important Service Traits for LIGHT RAIL Customers by Light Rail Line and Score

Customer Satisfaction Survey
Spring 2024

Light Rail System

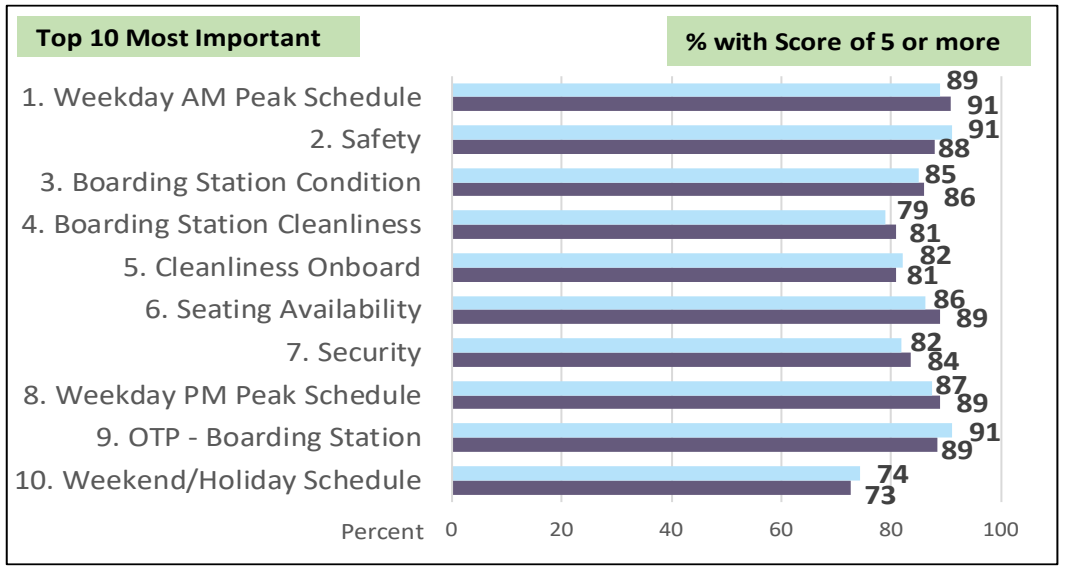


Hudson Bergen Light Rail

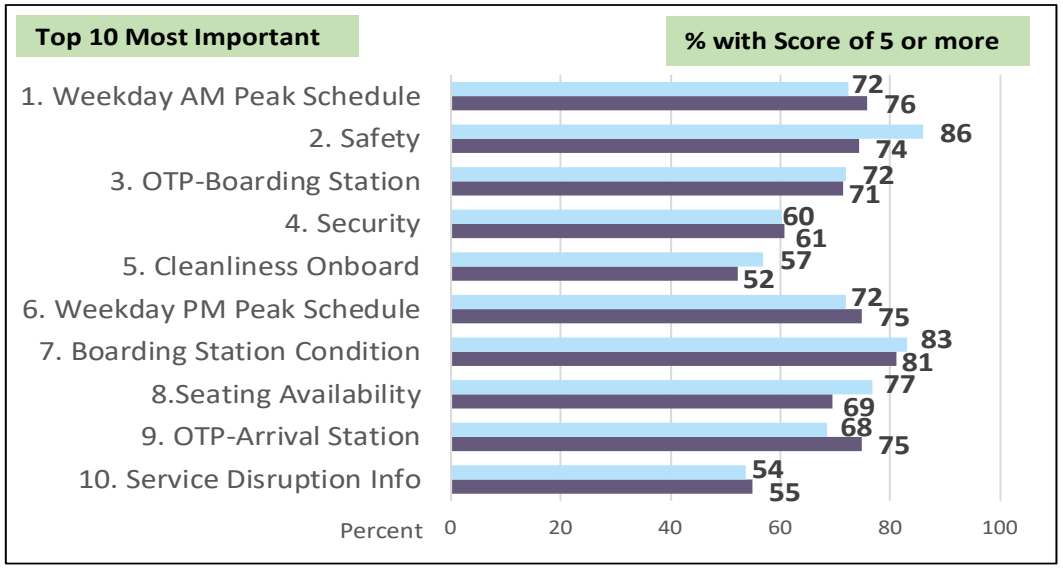


Spring 2024
Fall 2023

Newark Light Rail



River LINE

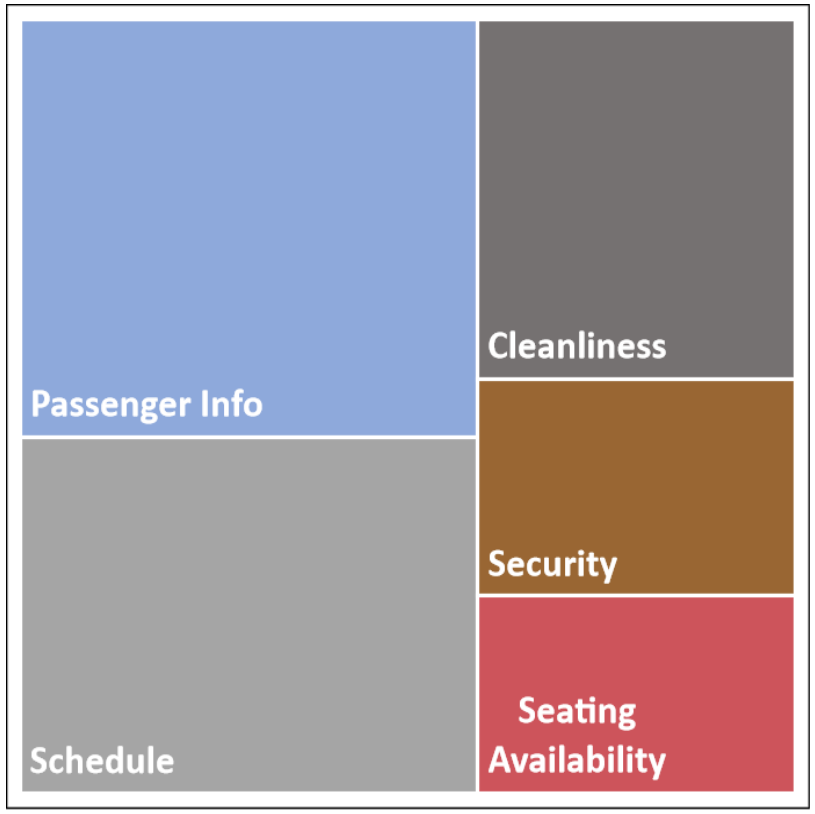


TRANSIT

Top Topic Areas of LIGHT RAIL Comments

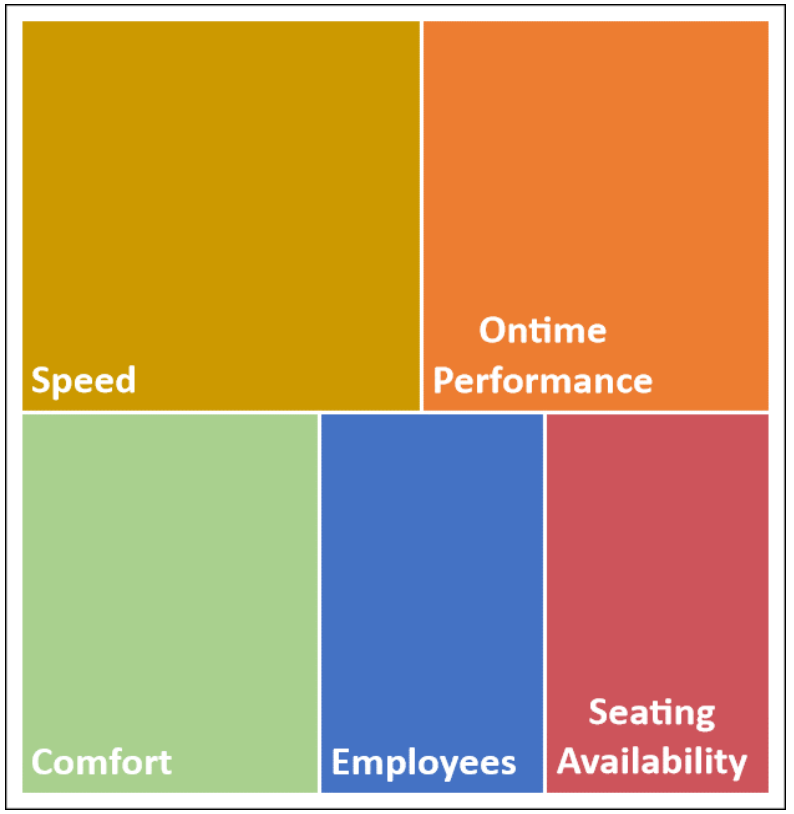
Customer Satisfaction Survey
Spring 2024

What is one thing we can do to **IMPROVE** your travel experience?



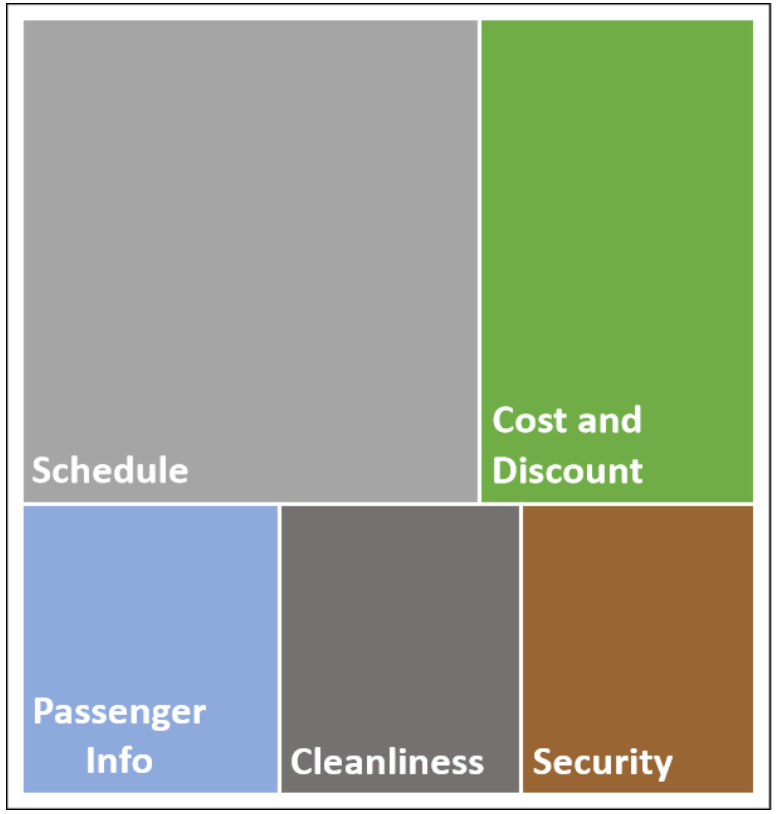
1324 "Improve" Comments

What is one thing that you **LIKED** about your trip on NJ TRANSIT?



1260 "Liked" Comments

What are the actions we could take to **ENCOURAGE** you to travel by NJ TRANSIT more frequently?



1237 "Encourage" Comments

2,122 Light Rail Surveys

TRANSIT

Customer Satisfaction Survey

Light Rail Score Context

Hudson-Bergen Light Rail

- Scores related to AM/PM peak scheduling and general on-time performance remain steady due to ongoing efforts to deliver optimal service
- Satisfaction with station cleanliness and passenger security has increased, with HBLR operations utilizing customer feedback to enhance and maintain stations and coordinating further with NJTPD to continue to prioritize passenger safety and ensure timely response for all events and incidents
- Weekend/holiday scheduling score has dropped slightly from previous survey period; HBLR operations continues to ensure advisories and other communications are made to alert passengers of upcoming weekend work, while also mitigating the impact that necessary weekend work has on operating service, such as “piggybacking” projects on the same weekend in the same area to minimize impact to service overall

NJ TRANSIT

Customer Satisfaction Survey

Light Rail Score Context

Newark Light Rail

- Scores pertaining to scheduling and general on-time performance remained steady, with increases in satisfaction for NLR's handling of service disruptions and arrival/departure performance
- While customer satisfaction with security has decreased slightly, passenger safety has increased; NLR will continue to coordinate with NJTPD to maintain and improve presence and overall response to incidents
- Satisfaction with both station and vehicle condition and cleanliness has increased from the previous survey period; efforts to maintain cleanliness will continue while also utilizing customer feedback for specific incidents

TRANSIT

Customer Satisfaction Survey

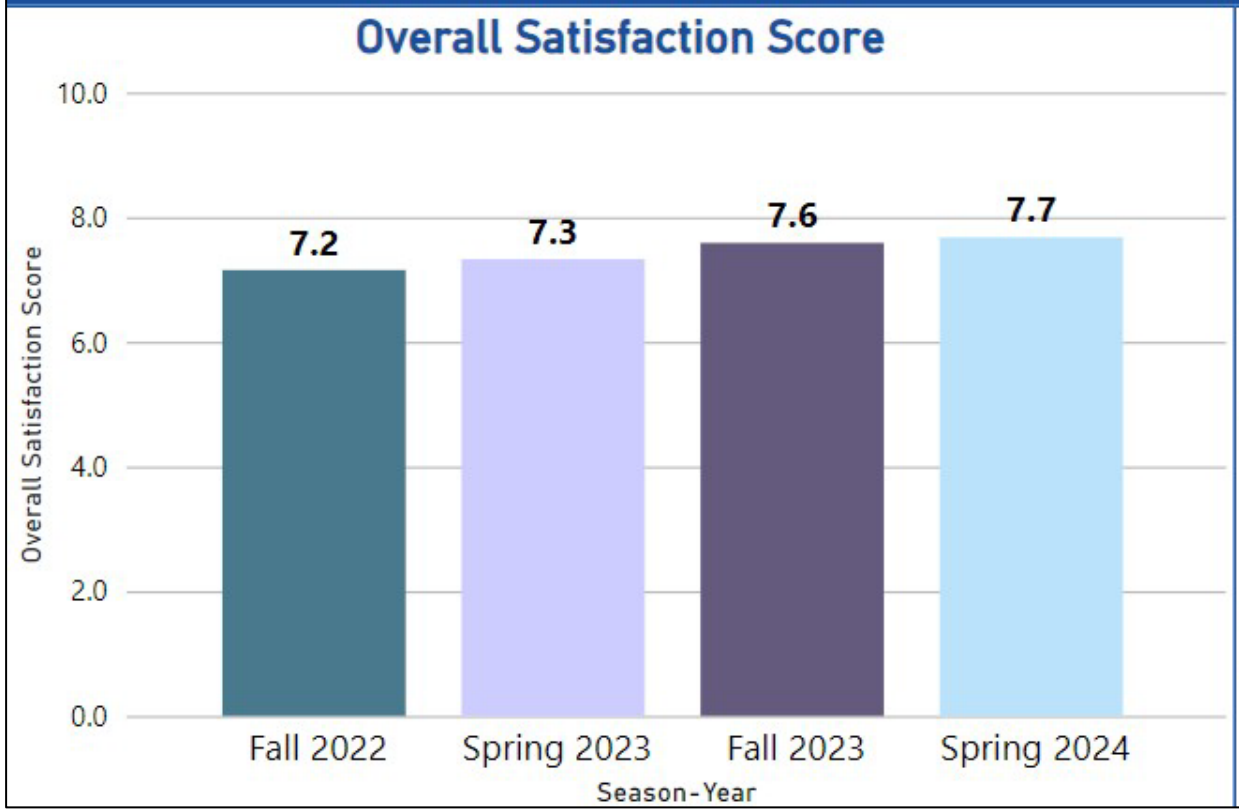
Light Rail Score Context

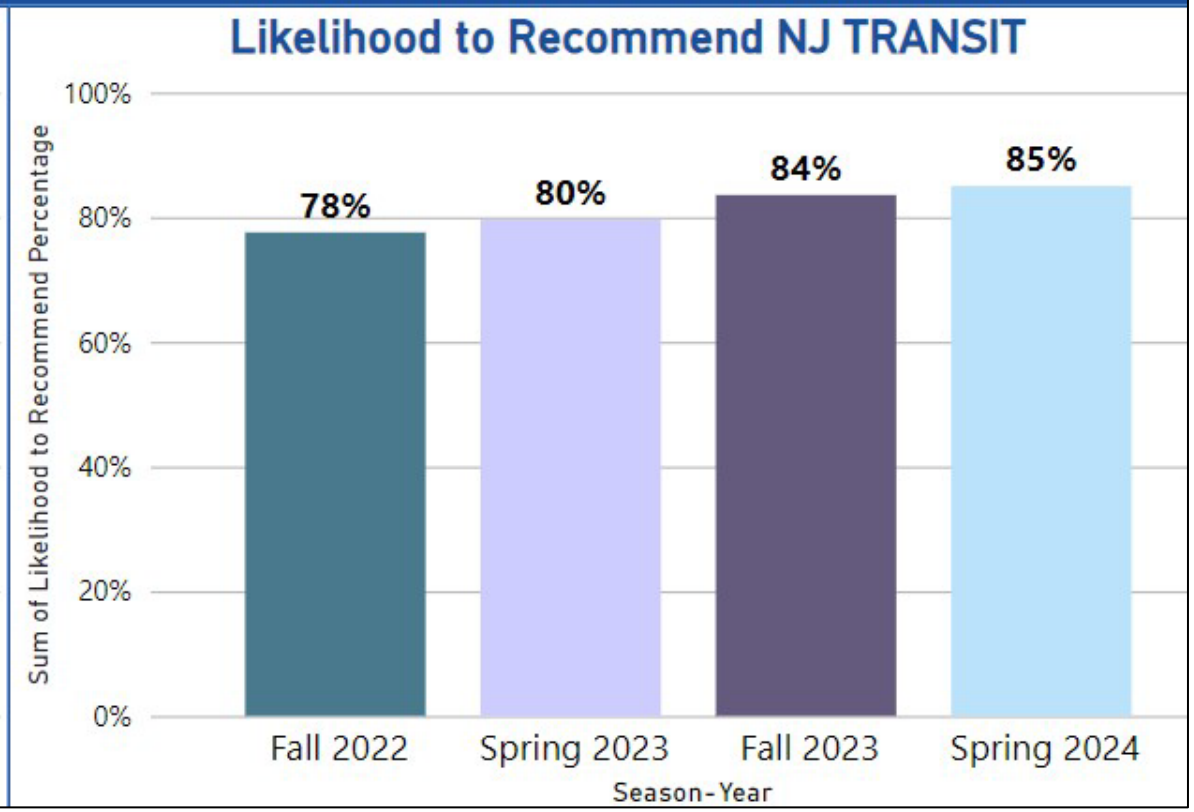
River Line

- Security Measures in Place:
  - Police Department's Skywatch deployed btw stations (36th & PTC)
  - Increased patrols
  - Fare Enforcement department active on the line
- Addressing Theft Issues:
  - Main cause: Passengers leaving belongings behind
  - Action: ALSTOM creating operations bulletin for operators
  - Operators to remind customers to take belongings when exiting
- Community Involvement:
  - Promoting "See Something, Say Something" campaign
  - Encourage reporting of crimes for police investigation
- Tackling Vandalism:
  - Sharing graffiti tag photos with police
  - Result: Successful arrest made
- Improving Cleanliness:
  - Focus on Light Rail Vehicles (LRVs)
  - Developing plan between Vehicle Maintenance and MOW departments
  - Ensuring 3rd party cleaning crew performance
  - Implementing quality checks before vehicles enter service

TRANSIT

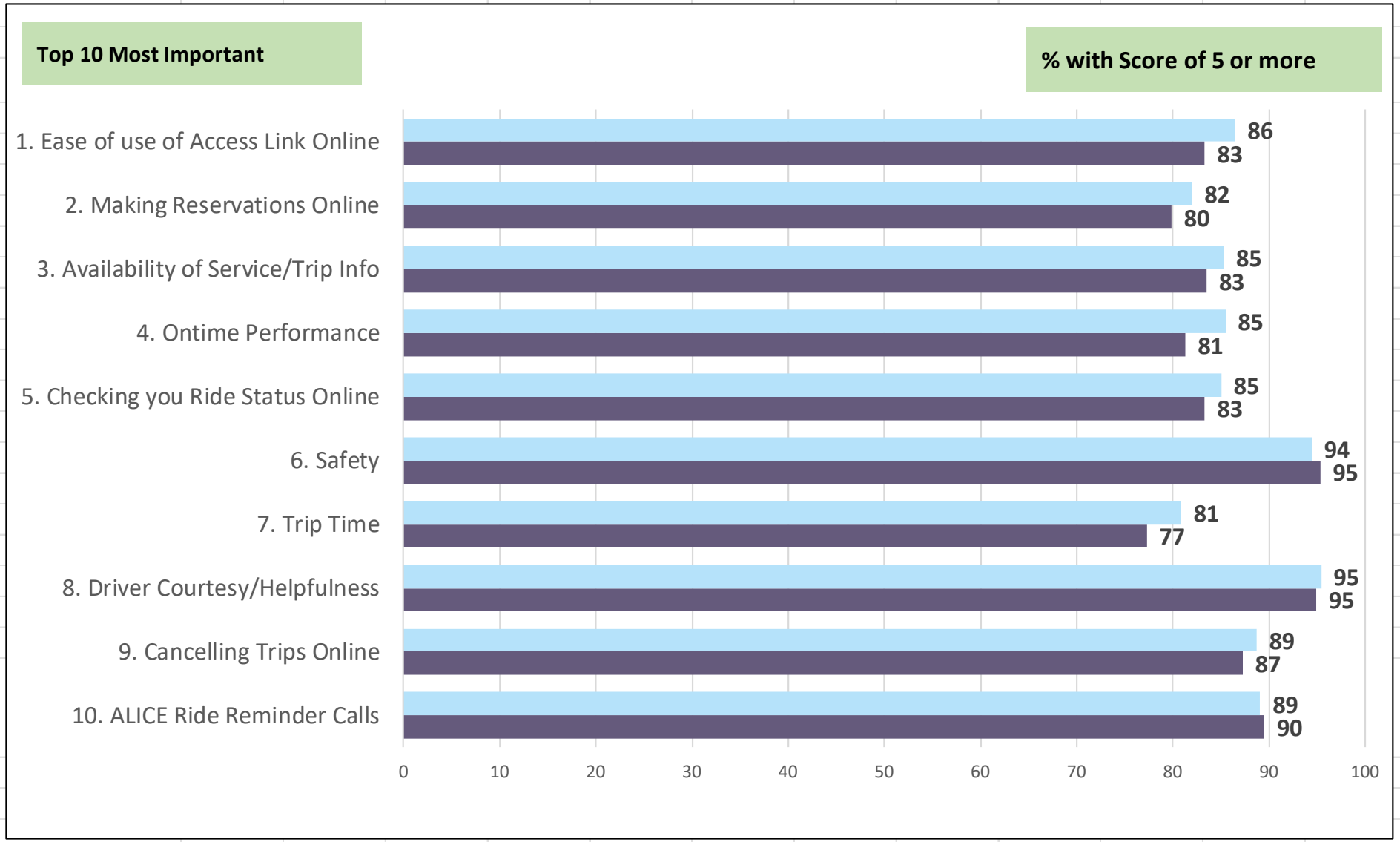
Access Link System





TRANSIT

Top 10 Most Important Service Traits for Access Link Customers

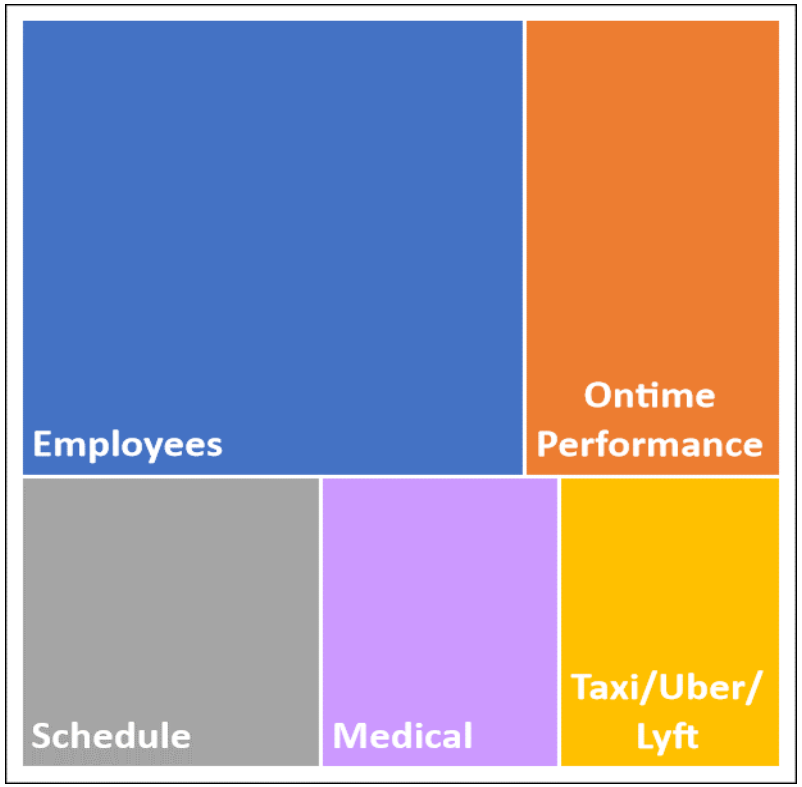


TRANSIT

Top Topic Areas of Access Link Comments

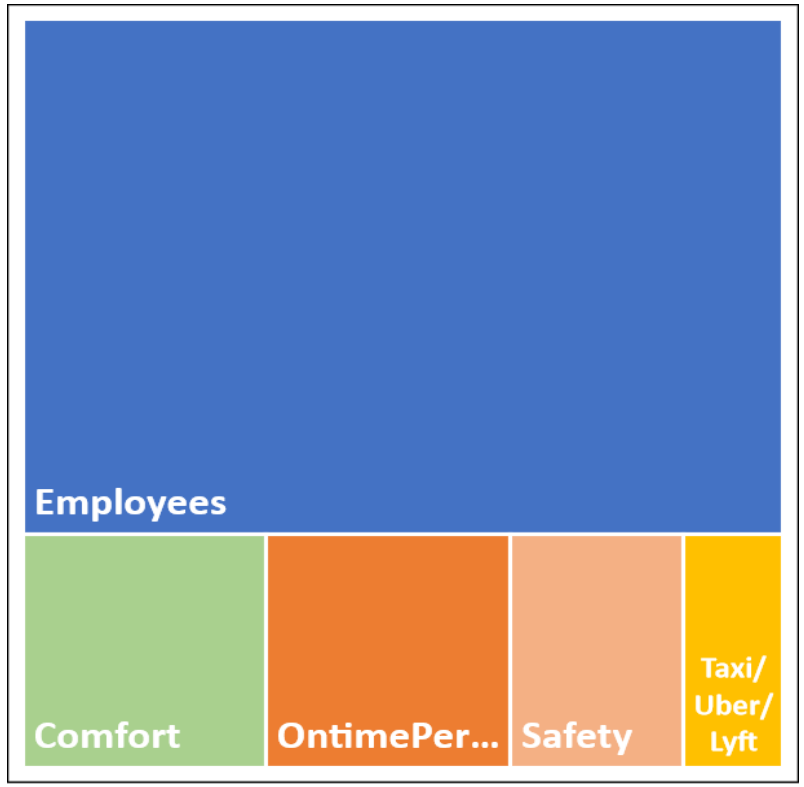
Customer Satisfaction Survey
Spring 2024

What is one thing we can do to **IMPROVE** your travel experience?



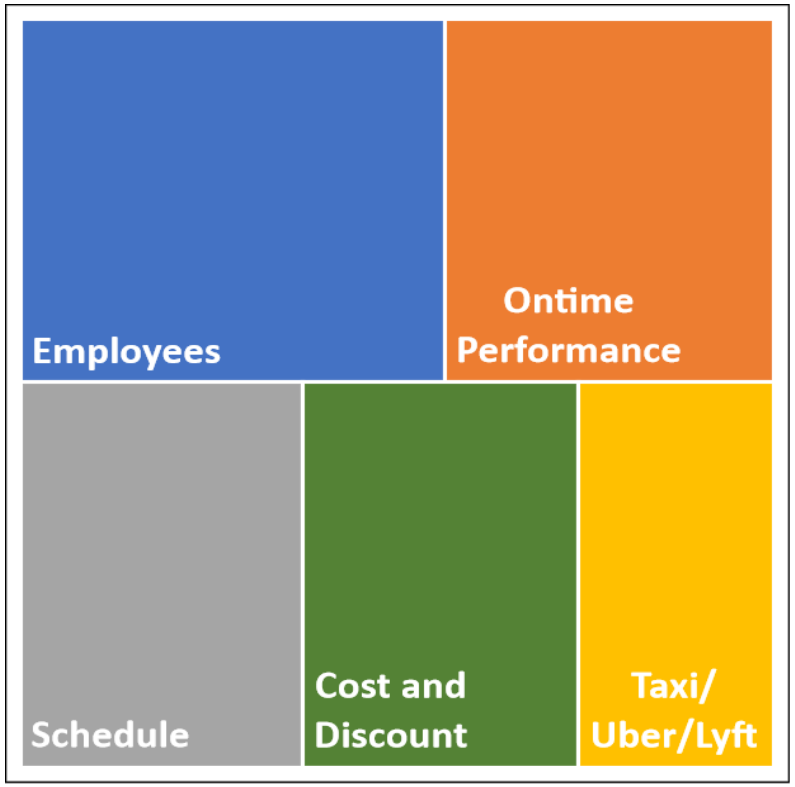
933 "Improve" Comments

What is one thing that you **LIKED** about your trip on NJ TRANSIT?



917 "Liked" Comments

What are the actions we could take to **ENCOURAGE** you to travel by NJ TRANSIT more frequently?



854 "Encourage" Comments

1,611 Access Link Surveys

TRANSIT

Customer Satisfaction Survey

Access Link Score Context

Access Link Riders' Choice Pilot

- Riders' Choice Pilot Program continues to have a positive impact on the Access Link customer experience
- In February 2024, the Access Link Riders' Choice pilot began shifting participants to the updated pilot (Access Link Riders' Choice Pilot 2.0) in Region 2 (Burlington, Camden, Gloucester, and Salem counties) and Region 5 (Essex, Morris, Somerset, and Union counties)
- Pilot participants in Region 4 (Mercer, Middlesex, Monmouth, and North Ocean counties) and Region 6 (Bergen, Passaic, and Hudson counties) were shifted to the 2.0 pilot in June 2024
- As of this June 310,909 TNC trips have been provided in the Access Link Riders' Choice Pilot 1.0 to the original 4,700 participants

TRANSIT

Customer Satisfaction Survey

Access Link Score Context

IVR AI (Replicant Software)

- Enhancements to the interactive voice response (IVR) telephone system continue to have a positive impact on scores related to Communications
- With the ability to reserve ride added to the system last fall, customers will also soon be able to reserve trips that include transfers
- Customers benefit from instant service with no hold times and 24/7 availability over the phone, while the enhanced system increases the availability of live agents to focus on more complex requests

TRANSIT

Access Link Score Context

On-Time Performance

- Implementation of the Service Infraction (No-Show) policy has contributed to the increase in satisfaction with on-time performance in most regions, with the No-Show rate having steadily reduced from nearly 10 percent to less than half
- Improves on-time performance and ride times by holding customers accountable for trips that arrive at the customer's pick-up location on time, but the customer is not there to board and did not call in advance to cancel their reservation
- Each no-show results in at least a 10-minute delay to a trip while confirmation procedures are followed, in addition to the unnecessary travel time experienced by other customers on that trip
- The policy uses a progressive scale of warnings and actions for repeated no-shows so that we can better serve customers who are consistently showing up for their pick-ups

Customer Satisfaction Survey

Summary

- 2024 Spring Overall Satisfaction with NJ TRANSIT Score is 6.6
- 80 percent of customers would recommend NJ TRANSIT
- The scores and customer comments have been shared with the operating groups and executive management
- Scores will be posted on the NJ TRANSIT website
- The next survey will be administered in the Fall of 2024

TRANSIT